Benchmarking MICA against ModelAngelo, EModelX(+AF) and newer deep-learning model builders on cryo-EM maps released in 2026

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Code, entry list, environments and raw per-entry metrics:
https://github.com/Zohaib-Bioinfo/mica-benchmark

Abstract

MICA builds protein models from cryo-EM maps by combining the density with AlphaFold 3 (AF3) predictions. I benchmarked it on 20 single-particle entries whose maps and models were released in 2026 (resolution 1.24–3.50 Å, 173–682 modelled residues) against ModelAngelo, EModelX(+AF) and four newer deep-learning methods, EMProt, E3-CryoFold, CryoAtom and CryoZeta; the last two were added after the first version of this report, at the request of Prof. Cheng. The entries were chosen by rules fixed before any run; every method ran with the settings of its own README on free Kaggle machines, the methods with an AF3 input got the same predictions, and one script scored every model against the deposited model. MICA built a model for 17 of the 20 entries (two runs were killed for lack of RAM, one reached its time limit); its median TM-score was 0.94 (mean 0.94, 95 % CI 0.91–0.96). On the entries where both built a model (differences are method minus MICA), EModelX(+AF) did not differ from MICA (0.00, 95 % CI −0.02 to 0.03), EMProt was slightly higher (0.04, 0.02 to 0.06; Holm p <0.001), E3-CryoFold was lower (−0.08; Holm p = 0.034), ModelAngelo was lower on the maps above 3.0 Å (−0.30, −0.48 to −0.13; Holm p = 0.098, borderline) but not on the maps up to 3.0 Å, and CryoAtom, which built a model for 16 entries and ran out of GPU memory on the other 4, did not differ from MICA (−0.06, −0.15 to 0.02; Holm p = 1.000). CryoZeta, whose README asks for a 32 GB GPU, ran on the free 15 GB GPUs as far as the free GPU time reached: it built a model for 11 entries, failed on 6 and was not run on 3; on the 11 entries where both built a model it was higher than MICA (0.05, 0.02 to 0.07; Holm p = 0.034, t-test 0.033), on a subset that is not a random sample of the twenty. Free compute forced two deviations from MICA's own pipeline, a coarse docking search and the omission of its real-space refinement, which the Phenix version available here would not run; both are described with their probable effects. The sample is small, and the conclusions apply to maps of up to 682 modelled residues. Code, the frozen entry list, environments and the raw per-entry metrics are public.

About this version. This is the second version of the report. The first (30 October 2026) covered MICA, ModelAngelo, EModelX(+AF), EMProt and E3-CryoFold. On 31 October 2026 Prof. Cheng asked me to add two methods, CryoAtom and CryoZeta. *Both are added in this version* (Section 2.5) and are marked with † in Table 1. CryoAtom ran on all 20 entries. CryoZeta, whose README asks for a GPU with 32 GB, ran on the 15 GB GPUs of the free machine as far as the free GPU time reached: it has a model for 11 entries, failed on 6 and was not run on 3, so its results are for a subset of the entries that is not a random sample (Sections 2.5 and 6.3). The entries, the AF3 inputs, the scoring protocol, the measures and the statistical tests are those of the first version. The Holm correction now covers six method pairs instead of four, so the adjusted p-values of the earlier methods are somewhat larger than before: for E3-CryoFold (Wilcoxon) 0.020 in the first version and 0.034 now; for ModelAngelo above 3.0 Å 0.059 (Wilcoxon) and 0.041 (t-test) in the first version and 0.098 and 0.055 now. The t-test for ModelAngelo above 3.0 Å no longer falls below 0.05; no other conclusion about the earlier methods changes. The new text is in Sections 2.5 and 6; the tables and figures list CryoAtom and CryoZeta as well.

1 Introduction

Building an atomic model of a protein from a cryo-EM density map is still largely manual. MICA (Gyawali et al., 2025) automates it by combining the map with structures predicted by AlphaFold 3 (AF3; Abramson et al., 2024), and its authors report a clear advantage over ModelAngelo (Jamali et al., 2024) and EModelX(+AF) (Chen et al., 2024), including a mean TM-score of 0.93 on a set of recently released maps. This report asks a narrower question that a reader can check: *how well does MICA build protein models on maps that were released in 2026, and how does it compare with the same two baselines and with newer methods, when everything runs on free compute and every method gets the same inputs?*

The test set is made of EMDB maps and PDB models that were both released between 1 January and 12 October 2026 (the freeze date). Twenty entries were chosen by a rule that was fixed before any model was run (Section 3). Seven methods were run with default settings and no per-map tuning, six of them on all twenty entries and CryoZeta on as many as the free GPU time allowed (Section 2; CryoAtom and CryoZeta were added after the first version of this report, Section 2.5); every output was scored in one session with one set of tools against the deposited model (Sections 4 and 5). Failed runs stay in every table, and a sensitivity analysis scores them as zero. With about twenty entries the report puts effect sizes and confidence intervals before *p*-values.

Findings in brief. MICA built a model for 17 of the 20 entries (median TM-score 0.94). The other methods were equal, slightly higher or lower depending on the method and the resolution; only the differences to EMProt and to CryoZeta are clear on both statistical tests (Section 6.3), and CryoZeta finished only 11 of the 20 entries. Two deviations from MICA's own pipeline, forced by free compute, and the small sample limit what can be concluded (Section 7).

2 Methods

2.1 The seven methods

MICA is the method under test. Two baselines are the ones that its paper compares with, ModelAngelo and EModelX(+AF); four are newer deep-learning model builders, EMProt, E3-CryoFold, CryoAtom and CryoZeta. EMProt and E3-CryoFold passed a published screen (Section 2.4); CryoAtom, which had passed it, and CryoZeta, which had been kept in reserve, were added after the first version of this report (Section 2.5). Every method ran with the settings of the example in its own README, with no per-map tuning. Table 1 gives the version, the inputs and the file that was scored for each. All methods that accept predicted structures got the same AlphaFold 3 (AF3) predictions; ModelAngelo, E3-CryoFold, CryoAtom and CryoZeta, which have no such input, got the map and the sequence only (CryoZeta also an alignment of every chain).

2.2 MICA and how it was run here

MICA combines the cryo-EM map with AF3 predictions in three programs (Gyawali et al., 2025). Program 1 splits every AF3 prediction into domains (Merizo; Lau et al., 2023). Program 2 docks each domain into the map with Phenix `dock_in_map` (Liebschner et al., 2019). Program 3 resamples the map to 1 Å voxels, predicts maps window by window with a 3D neural network (windows of 64^3 voxels, step 48), which takes the docked AF3 models as extra input channels, builds the chains from these predictions and from the AF3 structures, completes the side chains with Pulchra (Rotkiewicz and Skolnick, 2008) and refines the model against the map with Phenix real-space refinement (Afonine et al., 2018). MICA's code and weights are used as released (commit `726d1bb14b`); the network, the building of the chains and the refinement are not changed. Four things differ from the way the authors run MICA, each forced by free compute; the evidence is below or in Section 4.4, and the effects are discussed in Sections 6.6 and 7:

1. **Docking.** On a test entry (26DK, one chain of 191 residues, 3.5 Å) MICA's own docking call

Table 1. The methods and how they were run. All commits are pinned in `methods/methods_table.csv` and in the run information of each session. The scored file is the one fixed before any score was seen (Section 5). † Added after the first version of this report (Section 2.5).

Method	Paper	Commit	Inputs used here; file that is scored
MICA	Gyawali et al. (2025)	`726d1bb14b`	Map and one AF3 prediction per unique chain, docked into the map by MICA's program 2 (Section 2.2). Scored: `MICA_all_atom_model.pdb`.
ModelAngelo	Jamali et al. (2024)	`994945bdfa`	Map and sequence; no AlphaFold input (`model_angelo build`). Scored: the sequence-assigned model.
EModelX(+AF)	Chen et al. (2024)	`53713cf820`	Map, sequence and the AF3 predictions as templates (protocol `temp_flex`, no AlphaFold database download). Scored: `all_atom_model.pdb` (after Pulchra).
EMProt	Li et al. (2026)	`9489d52e7f`	Map, sequence and the AF3 predictions as per-chain models (`emprot build ... -chain`). Scored: `output.cif`.
E3-CryoFold	Wang et al. (2025)	`241cef48da`	Map and sequence (`inference.py -protocol pre_align -t 0.1`); no AlphaFold input. Scored: the `pre_align` model.
CryoAtom†	Su et al. (2026)	`e2a31f2b2f`	Map and sequence (`python -m CryoAtom build -s FASTA -v MAP -o OUT`, v1.0.0); no AlphaFold input. Scored: the model `<name>.cif` (after pruning).
CryoZeta†	Zhang et al. (2026)	`c544c6bbd0`	Map, sequence and a multiple sequence alignment (MSA) of every unique chain from the ColabFold server (`cryozeta-detection`, then `cryozeta-inference`, settings of the demo); no AlphaFold input. Scored: sample 0, the best of five samples (`<name>_sample_0.cif`).

(Phenix molecular replacement, no time limit) did not finish in 66 minutes on a 4-core, 31 GB Kaggle machine and was then killed by the system for lack of RAM. Program 2 is therefore run through a small driver that imports MICA's own file and replaces only the method that calls Phenix: `dock_in_map` in its Fourier-search mode with `quick=True`, at 6 Å (then 10 Å), with a time limit per domain. The placements are coarse (Section 6.6).

2. **No docked input where nothing can be docked.** If no domain of an entry docks, MICA still runs without docked AF3 input, which its README describes as an option ("skip this step if you don't want to use AF3 at input level"); the AF3 channels of the network are then zero. The AF3 structures are still used when MICA builds the chains. Every MICA result is labelled by its docking mode: *full* (every domain docked), *partial* or *none*.
3. **Program 3 on a GPU, one window at a time.** MICA predicts windows in batches of up to 8 when a map has more than 200 windows. That setting (`batch_threshold = 200` in `utils/predict.py`) exceeded the 15 GB of a T4 on the first three large maps. In the GPU sessions of the second and third round it is raised to 10^6, so that every window is predicted alone, as MICA does for small maps. This changes memory use only.
4. **No real-space refinement.** MICA's last step, Phenix real-space refinement with the parameter file shipped in MICA's repository (written for Phenix 1.20.1), stops with a parameter error in the only Phenix version available here (2.2.1-6174: "Incompatible parameter objects: scope `cdl_nucleotides`"). It stopped with this error in every one of the 25 program-3 runs of the GPU sessions that built a model (the main sessions and the session without docked input; the run logs are in the repository), while the program itself reports exit code 0. The scored file is therefore MICA's all-atom model after Pulchra and before refinement, chosen before any MICA result existed because it is the program's own output. Refinement moves atoms only a little and is not expected to change the TM-score much, but its effect on the other metrics is not measured (Section 7).

2.3 The baselines

ModelAngelo (Jamali et al., 2024) was run as `model_angelo build -v MAP -pf FASTA -o OUT -device 0` with the default weights bundle. *EModelX(+AF)* (Chen et al., 2024) was run in its AlphaFold mode (`-protocol=temp_flex`) with the AF3 predictions as the templates of its README example (one folder per sequence with `ranked_0.pdb`), followed by Pulchra. Feeding AF3 models to it is a protocol choice made so that all methods with an AlphaFold input get the same predictions. *EMProt* (Li et al., 2026) was run as `emprot build -map MAP -seq FASTA -chain <AF3 models> -device 0`. *E3-CryoFold* (Wang et al., 2025) was run with the `pre_align` protocol of its README example; its `denovo` protocol is not part of the benchmark. *CryoAtom* (Su et al., 2026) (v1.0.0, the code of the paper; its successor CryoAtom2 is a preprint and was not used) was run as `python -m CryoAtom build -s FASTA -v MAP -o OUT`, the command of its README, with the weights of the authors' server and the ESM-2 language model that the program loads; it has no AlphaFold input. *CryoZeta* (Zhang et al., 2026) (no release tag; its weights are free for academic and non-commercial research only) was run with the two programs of its README: `cryozeta-detection`, a 3D network that finds Cα positions in the map (the contour level is the one recommended in the EMDB header), and `cryozeta-inference`, a diffusion model that builds the structure from the sequence, an MSA of every unique chain and these detections. The MSAs came from the public ColabFold server (the README names the ColabFold search as the way to get them); the server's alignments carry no species, so the chains of a complex are not paired across sequences. The settings are those of the demo of the authors (seed 101, 5 samples, 20 diffusion steps, 10 EMPairformer cycles, bfloat16 numbers). The compiled kernels of the demo script (DeepSpeed and cuEquivariance attention, a fast layer norm) need a CUDA compiler and an Ampere GPU and are off; the program has a plain implementation of each. The program ranks its five samples and writes the best as sample 0, which is the model of the benchmark; the other four are scored next to it (Appendix, Table A15). No line of its source was changed.

2.4 Selection of the newer methods

The newer methods were chosen with a screen that was written down before the search (spec decision 2): a method had to be published after both baselines, use deep learning, build protein atomic models from a map and a sequence, have public code and weights, run on a free 16 GB GPU and have documented defaults. A literature and repository search (to 11 October 2026) screened 29 methods: 3 passed (CryoAtom, EMProt and E3-CryoFold), 2 were kept in reserve (EM3DFold, a preprint; CryoZeta, which needs 32 GB of GPU memory) and 24 were excluded, each with a reason (Appendix, Table A1). CryoAtom (Su et al., 2026) was first dropped before the production runs, as the first scope cut of the spec allows: in a pilot on the smallest entry neither of its two versions finished within 2 hours, and at the floor of 12 entries it would have needed more GPU hours than one weekly quota. The first version of this report therefore had two newer methods, not three. The decision did not depend on any result. CryoAtom and CryoZeta were added afterwards at the request of Prof. Cheng (Section 2.5). Forward citations of MICA could not be searched (the citation databases were not reachable from the workspace), so the screen may have missed methods that only a citation search finds.

2.5 Methods added after the first version

After the first version of this report, Prof. Cheng asked me (31 October 2026) to add CryoAtom and CryoZeta to the benchmark. I added them and did not replace any method, and I wrote the decisions into the project log before any run of either method. The twenty entries, the AF3 inputs, the scoring protocol, the measures and the statistical tests are unchanged; the one change of the analysis is that the Holm correction covers the pairs of all added methods with MICA (six pairs in this version, four in the first). The first version of the report stays as it was sent. Four rules are specific to the added methods:

- **Run limit.** 10 hours per run for CryoAtom, against 3 hours for the other baselines, because its

pilot did not finish within 2 hours, and 6 hours for CryoZeta, half of a 12-hour session. The longer limits are a favour to both methods: 2 of the CryoAtom models (26DK (231 min) and 9VI4 (395 min)) and 2 of the CryoZeta models (9JKK (224 min) and 9OTA (196 min)) took longer than the 3 hours of the other baselines and would have been failures under their limit. No CryoAtom run reached 10 hours; the limit of 6 hours stopped 3 of the CryoZeta runs (9VBD, 9VUH and 9Z24).

- **GPU memory.** A CUDA out-of-memory error on the 15 GB GPU is a failed run of the method on this hardware and not a fault of the installation (the README of CryoAtom asks for 13 to 14 GB, that of CryoZeta for 32 GB); the notebook records it as such, and the entries stay in every table. No larger GPU was used, so these entries were not run again. CryoZeta starts with its default attention chunk size of 256 and, after an out-of-memory error, tries 64, 16 and 4, a setting that changes the memory and the time but not the algorithm; the entry is failed only when all four attempts have failed. A run that stops for another reason is repeated once in float32.
- **One line of the source of CryoAtom is changed**, so that two programs can run at the same time (one per GPU, as for the other methods): the program writes the profile of every chain to the fixed file `/tmp/CryoAtom_temp.hmm`, which two programs would overwrite and delete, and the change adds the process number to the file name. The notebook checks that the line occurs exactly once, and the change is saved as `cryoatom_source_patch.diff` in the run record. Nothing else of the program is changed.
- **CryoZeta ran on as many entries as the free GPU time allowed.** A CryoZeta run takes from 6 min to several hours on the T4 (Table A17), and the free machine allowed four sessions with two programs at a time, in which not all twenty entries fit. The entries ran in an order that was written down before they had a result: in the order of the entry list in the first session and, for the entries still without a result, the smallest deposited model first in the second and the third (an entry that the system had killed went first and alone, and the entry that an earlier session had cut last). The list of the fourth session was set by hand to 9VUH, 9WFL and 9WME, with 9VUH first and alone; 9VI4 was not in it. A run that the system kills while the other GPU is busy is run again alone, as for the other baselines, and a kill while alone is a failure (26DK, in the detection step of the program, in the first two sessions, and 9OC0 in the same step in the third). An entry that was not started, was cut by the end of a session or was killed without time for a second run is *not run*: it is not a failure of the method, it is left out of the comparisons and it is marked N in the tables. The results of CryoZeta are therefore those of the 11 entries that it finished, a subset that is not random; it was not run on 9VI4, 9WFL and 9WME.

CryoAtom ran in a notebook of its own (the scheduler, the two GPUs and the scoring are those of the other methods) on all 20 entries in one GPU session, and was scored in a separate CPU session with the same code. CryoZeta ran in the same kind of notebook in four GPU sessions that ran entries; an earlier one ended with a set-up error before any entry was run (two data files of the program had not been downloaded; the notebook was corrected), and the first start of the third stopped after 25 seconds at the check of the internet (one TLS time-out; the check now asks again). Its models were scored in two CPU sessions; the two scoring sessions that followed the last two GPU sessions stopped by themselves, because those sessions had built no model (Table A5).

3 Datasets

3.1 Selection of the entries

The test set was fixed before any method was run (spec decisions 3 to 5; the entry list was committed on 16 October 2026). An entry qualifies when its EMDB map and its PDB model were both released between 1 January and 12 October 2026, so that no method can have been tuned on it by the authors of the maps. The release date of every map was checked in the EMDB, and the pool was frozen on 12 October. The filters were applied to the metadata and the files of the deposition:

- single-particle reconstruction, resolution of 4.0 Å or better, one EMDB map per entry;
- protein only (no nucleic-acid chain), 1 to 700 modelled residues in total, at most 3 unique chain sequences, at most 5 % UNK residues;
- a map–model correlation CC_{mask} of at least 0.70, computed for every entry in the same way with Phenix `map_model_cc` at the resolution of the entry.

Table A2 (Appendix) shows how the pool of 6 116 cryo-EM entries released in the window shrinks to 484 candidates. The candidates were clustered with MMseqs2 (Steinegger and Söding, 2017) at 30 % sequence identity on the longest chain of each entry (179 clusters), so that no protein family is used twice. Two strata were defined by resolution (at most 3.0 Å, and above 3.0 up to 4.0 Å). In each stratum the candidates were put in a random order (seed 2026) and the first 10 that passed every filter were taken; an entry whose cluster or map was already used was skipped. The CC_{mask} rule removed 6 entries (all in the lower-resolution stratum) and 2 more because Phenix could not compute it (a charged-oxygen atom type that its scattering table does not know). The seed, the shuffle and every skipped entry are recorded in the selection log of the repository.

3.2 The twenty entries

The final list has 20 entries, 10 per stratum (Table A3 in the Appendix). Resolutions range from 1.24 to 3.50 Å; the deposited models hold 173 to 682 residues (median 454); 13 entries have one protein chain and 7 have several chains, some of them copies. The maps range from 16 MB to 1 GB. Because the rule takes one entry per cluster and the seeded order decides which one, the list favours common specimens only to the extent that the pool does (seven clusters hold a quarter of the candidates); the cluster sizes of the chosen entries are in the repository.

How new is the protein? The maps are new, but the proteins often are not. For every unique chain we recorded the highest sequence identity to any chain of a PDB entry released before 2026 (MMseqs2 search against `pdb_seqres`, alignments covering at least half of the chain). 13 entries have a chain with 95 % identity or more to an older entry (for example 22FX, human apoferritin), 4 lie between 44 and 76 %, and only 3 (9TKA, 9VBD and 26DK) are at 0 %. Training data of the methods are not known in detail, so a method may have seen a homologue of a test protein. The planned sensitivity analysis on the subset at 30 % identity or less has 3 entries, too few for a test; it is described in Section 6 and not tested.

3.3 AlphaFold 3 inputs

One AF3 prediction was made for each of the 26 unique chain sequences of the 20 entries with AlphaFold Server (default settings, random seed, no custom templates); the first model (`model_0`) is used by every method that takes predicted structures. The mean pLDDT of the predictions ranges from 62.4 to 97.5 (median 87.0); the chains with most residues below 50 are 9VUH chain E3 (43 %), 9V4D chain E1 (25 %) and 9VUH chain E2 (22 %). A nine-residue peptide with an unknown first residue (9V4D chain E2) was submitted with glycine in its place. Each prediction was checked against its submitted sequence. The predictions are not published in the repository (the Server terms allow non-commercial research use only); the job list, the checks and the file hashes are.

4 Benchmarking procedure

4.1 Compute and software

The pool of 2026 releases and the map–model correlation of the candidates (Section 3) were computed in free Google Colab notebooks; every run of a method and all scoring ran on free Kaggle notebooks. No paid service was used. A GPU session has two NVIDIA Tesla T4 GPUs (15360 MiB each), 4 CPU cores and 31.3 GB of RAM; a CPU session has the same cores and memory and no GPU. Phenix 2.2.1-6174 was installed with the author's academic licence (the installer is not redistributed); US-align and every method were installed from pinned commits (Table A4). Each

session wrote the output of `nvidia-smi`, the number of cores, the memory, the package versions and the hashes of its input files into its result zip. The notebooks are generated by scripts of the repository and were tested against stand-ins of the methods before they were run; the sessions that produced results are listed in Table A5. A result zip is unpacked by a script that keeps text files only (coordinate files stay in the notebook outputs).

4.2 Order of work

(1) The entries were selected and frozen, and the AF3 predictions were made (Section 3). (2) A pilot of every method on the smallest entry (26DK) fixed versions and commands before any production run. (3) The four non-MICA methods ran on all 20 entries in three batch sessions. (4) MICA ran in three stages: Merizo domain splitting and docking in CPU sessions, then the network and the model building in GPU sessions. (5) All models were scored in separate CPU sessions with one notebook code, using the protocol of Section 5, which was written down on 24 October, before any MICA model existed. (6) After the first version, CryoAtom ran on all 20 entries in a GPU session of its own, and CryoZeta ran on as many entries as the free GPU time allowed in four sessions; their models were scored in CPU sessions with the same code (Section 2.5). No entry was dropped or replaced after its first run, and no parameter was changed for a single map.

4.3 Rules for the runs

The rules below were written in the project log before the sessions that used them started; Table A8 lists every failure with its reason.

- **One run per method and entry.** A run that ends without the model file counts as failed, whatever the reason (crash, out-of-memory kill, timeout). Failed runs stay in every table and are scored as zero in a sensitivity analysis (Section 6).
- **Run limit.** 3 h for every run of the baselines; for MICA, 30 min for program 1, a limit for each docking call (Section 4.4) and 2 h (GPU) or 3 h (CPU) for program 3. Reaching a limit is a failure. The spec allowed 11 h per run; it was shortened because a weekly GPU quota of about 30 h could not carry hung runs. CryoAtom and CryoZeta, added later, had 10 h and 6 h per run (Section 2.5).
- **Two programs at a time.** A Kaggle GPU session has two GPUs; the baselines, CryoAtom and CryoZeta included, ran one program on each. Their run times are therefore wall-clock times with another program active, and only indicative. E3-CryoFold and EModelX(+AF) never ran at the same time, because both allocate arrays that grow with the square of the number of candidate atoms and ran out of RAM together in the pilot. A baseline that the system killed (exit code -9) while the other GPU was busy was run once more, alone; a kill while alone, a crash or a timeout is a failure at once.
- **Cut by the end of a session.** A run that the end of a session interrupted is not a result; it was run again in a later session.
- **GPU memory.** A CUDA out-of-memory error of CryoAtom or CryoZeta on the 15 GB GPU is a failed run of the method on this hardware and not a problem of the installation (Section 2.5); it stays in the tables and does not stop the notebook's guard, which pauses a method for the rest of a session after two other crashes in a row within an hour.
- **Order.** The baselines took the entries in the seeded order with the two strata interleaved, so that any prefix is balanced; nothing was dropped or left out because of a result.

4.4 MICA in three stages

Docking (program 2). The AF3 prediction of every chain was split into domains by Merizo (program 1; 59 domains in the 20 entries). Docking was run three times, always on CPU sessions of at most 12 h, and the three passes are all reported (Table A6). *Pass 1* called Phenix `dock_in_map` with `dock_with_mr=False quick=True` and at most 45 min per domain, followed (if the quick search had not run out of time) by a thorough search of at most 60 min; it docked 14 of 59 domains, with a median local correlation of 0.44. *Pass 2* was meant to search at coarser resolution, but

Phenix 2.2.1-6174 rejected the parameter that had been added (a True/False parameter where a number was passed), so the first two attempts stopped after one second and only the call of pass 1 ran again: 12 domains. This was an error in the set-up of the pass, found in the logs and recorded in `LOG.md`; it is the reason for a third pass. *Pass 3*, the set-up that counts, runs the whole docking, the search and the rigid-body refinement, at 6 Å (parameter `resolution=6.0`, at most 40 min per domain) and at 10 Å if that fails or runs out of time (25 min). It docked 46 of 59 domains, with a median local correlation of 0.09. That value is not comparable with the 0.44 of pass 1, because it is measured at 6 Å after a coarse refinement; I did not check the placements against the deposited models, and the only evidence that they help is indirect (Section 6.6). By entry, 14 entries have every domain docked (*full*), 5 have some (*partial*) and 1 has none (*none*; 9VI4).

Program 3 on a GPU. Program 3 of MICA deletes and rewrites its own output folders, so the notebook runs it for one entry at a time. A guard switches program 3 off for the rest of a session after two failures in a row, and the entries that wait then are marked *deferred* and run in a later session. The first GPU session used MICA's own batching and failed with a GPU out-of-memory error on the maps with many windows (Section 2.2); from then on `batch_threshold` was raised to 10^6 at run time, which was decided and logged before the rerun, and the notebook stops if the patch does not apply exactly once. In the first session 3 entries (22FX, 9WQ6 and 9V4D) failed; they ran again with the patch. This is an exception to the rule of one run per entry, which the spec allows only for runs killed by the platform. The first failure stays in Table A7, and the main analysis uses the rerun; if the reruns counted as failures, MICA would have 14 models (Section 6). Three entries have no MICA model after all sessions: 26DK and 9VI4 were killed by the system when the model-building step of MICA, which runs on one CPU core, used up the 31 GB of RAM (about 33 000 and 32 000 candidate atoms, as counted in the program logs), and 9OC0 reached the 2-hour limit of program 3 while it was filling the last gap of its last chain. Nothing else was running when 26DK and 9VI4 were killed.

A second MICA run without docked input. To get an indication of what the docked input is worth, a second GPU session ran program 3 from the same saved state with the docked AF3 models removed, so that the AF3 channels of the network are zero. It covers the 8 entries that the first GPU session built (Section 6.6); the equivalent sessions for the later entries were not run, because the GPU quota did not allow it.

4.5 Scoring and analysis

Every model file that a method wrote was scored in CPU sessions with the same notebook code. The scored file of each method is fixed in Table 1; further kinds of output (for example MICA's initial Cα model) were scored as well and are reported in the Appendix, but are not used in the main comparison. The analysis script reads the status tables of all sessions and the scores, takes the latest result of every method and entry (for MICA, only from the final docking set-up), and writes the tables, the figures and the numbers quoted in the text (as LaTeX macros), so that the numbers of the results are not typed in by hand; the few figures quoted from logs (for example the candidate atoms above) are marked as such. Its quality checks stop on a method that is unknown, an entry that is not in the frozen list, a score for a run that did not finish, and more than one primary model per method and entry; the check on entries that have both an *ok* and a *failed* result flags exactly the 3 MICA reruns above.

5 Evaluation metrics

5.1 Scoring protocol

Every model is compared with the deposited model of its entry (protein chains only, first model, first alternative location) with the same code and tools for every method. The protocol was written

Table 2. Measures of the accuracy of a model. The completion and the run time are defined with their results (Section 6). The TM-score is the primary measure (spec decision 7 and 8). N_{close} and N_{far} are the residues of the model that have a deposited Cα within 3.0 Å or not.

Measure	Definition	Tool
TM-score (primary)	Normalised by the length of the *deposited* model; multi-chain alignment with the chains paired one to one (`-mm 1 -ter 1`), so extra copies in the model are ignored.	US-align (Zhang et al., 2022; Zhang and Skolnick, 2004)
Aligned length, RMSD, sequence identity	Aligned Cα pairs of the same run, their RMSD (Å), and the share of them with the same residue type.	US-align
TM-score, fragment-agnostic	All chains of each structure joined into one chain and aligned without regard to residue order (`-mm 5`); fragment order, chain breaks and extra copies do not matter.	US-align
Cα match (%)	$100\,N_{\text{close}}/(N_{\text{close}}+N_{\text{far}})$: the share of the model's Cα atoms that lie within 3.0 Å of a deposited Cα (a precision).	`phenix.chain_comparison` (Liebschner et al., 2019)
Sequence match (%)	Share of the matched residues that have the residue type of the deposited residue.	`phenix.chain_comparison`
Coverage	Residues of the model divided by residues of the deposited model; above 1 means that the model has more residues than the deposit (extra copies or extra chains).	–
Cα quality score (%)	Cα match $\times$ coverage, as defined for the MICA paper and its predecessor; it equals the share of deposited residues found when $N_{\text{close}}+N_{\text{far}}$ equals the residues of the model, so built copies cancel out.	–

down on 24 October 2026, before any MICA model existed, and was not changed afterwards. A model with several chains, fragments or copies is scored as the method wrote it. Table 2 lists the measures: the six of the MICA paper (Gyawali et al., 2025) plus the Cα RMSD and the residue coverage, which I had named in my email to Prof. Cheng, and a fragment-agnostic TM-score that I added to read the first one correctly.

Reading the measures. Before `chain_comparison` each model is moved onto the deposited model with the rotation of the `-mm 1` run, because a map can hold symmetry copies of the deposited chain and a method may build another copy; the same measures without this step are in the Appendix. Two properties of the measures matter for the comparison. First, US-align's multi-chain mode aligns only one fragment per deposited chain: a model cut into many pieces scores low although each piece is right (a synthetic test gave 0.14 for a perfect model cut into seven fragments). ModelAngelo writes its models as several chains (median 4, up to 67; the deposited models have 1 to 4), so its TM-score mixes accuracy and continuity; the fragment-agnostic TM-score separates them. CryoAtom also writes several chains (median 4, up to 69). CryoZeta writes one chain for each chain of its input (median 1, up to 2), and its models hold more residues than the deposited ones (median coverage 1.17, up to 1.58). The models are written as PDB files with one-letter chain names, of which there are 62, so the names repeat from the 63rd chain on, and two CryoAtom models have more than 62 chains (9VI4 and 26DK); I therefore checked on synthetic models that the repeat does not change the TM-score: with one perfect chain among up to 120 chains, placed at six positions from 1 to 101, it was 1.0 wherever the perfect chain sat. The fragment-agnostic TM-score numbers the joined chains in one PDB file and could not be computed for the CryoAtom model of 9VI4, which has 30 911 residues, more than that format can number; Table A14 therefore counts 15 CryoAtom models, not 16. Second, the Cα match is a precision: a method that builds every copy it finds in the map (ModelAngelo, EMProt, CryoAtom), or more residues than the deposit models (CryoZeta), is penalised for what the deposited model does not contain, although

the deposited chain is built correctly. Conclusions therefore rest on the TM-score and the Cα quality score, and the other measures are shown next to them with the coverage.

5.2 Statistics

Each method is compared with MICA on the entries where both have a scored model; the number of pairs is always given, and every difference is *method minus MICA*. The primary test is the two-sided Wilcoxon signed-rank test on the TM-score; the paired *t*-test is given because the MICA paper uses it. Confidence intervals (95 %) are percentile bootstrap intervals over entries (10 000 resamples, seed 2026) for means, medians and mean differences. *p*-values are adjusted by Holm's method over the six method pairs, separately for each measure and group; they are not adjusted across measures, so every measure except the TM-score is exploratory. Results are given for all entries and for each resolution stratum. Failed runs are not missing data: a sensitivity analysis scores them as zero on every measure and compares the means over all 20 entries. The planned subset of low-identity entries has too few entries to test and is described. Spearman rank correlations with resolution, size and novelty are descriptive. With 17 pairs or fewer, differences of a few hundredths in the TM-score cannot be told from noise, so the report puts effect sizes and intervals before *p*-values.

6 Results

6.1 Completion

Table 3 shows how many of the 20 entries ended with a scored model. MICA built 17 (85 %), ModelAngelo 19 (95 %), EModelX(+AF) 18 (90 %), EMProt 19 (95 %), E3-CryoFold 15 (75 %), CryoAtom 16 (80 %) and CryoZeta 11 (55 %; 65 % of the 17 entries on which it was run). No run produced a file that could not be scored. The 9VI4 entry (1.8 Å, a 1 GB map) failed for the five methods of the first version, and 26DK for MICA, EModelX(+AF) and E3-CryoFold; CryoAtom built a model for both (its run on 9VI4 took 395 min), but ran out of GPU memory on 4 other entries, 13BD, 9OC0, 9VBD and 9Z24 (Table A8, Appendix). CryoZeta did not run on every entry (Section 2.5). It failed on 6: 26DK and 9OC0 (killed by the system in the detection step of the program, also when they ran alone), 9Z24 (out of GPU memory at the chunk sizes 256 and 64, the second after 5.3 hours, then the 6-hour limit in the third attempt), 13BD (out of GPU memory in all four attempts) and, at the 6-hour limit, 9VBD and 9VUH (9VUH was run a second time, alone, and reached the limit again). It was not run on 3 entries (9VI4, 9WFL and 9WME): the system killed the run on 9VI4 while the other GPU was busy and there was no time left to run it again alone, and 9WFL and 9WME were cut by the end of a session twice (9WME three times), after 4.1 to 4.9 hours, because the free GPU time was used up. These are not failures of the method; they are left out of the comparisons and marked N in the tables. The three failures of MICA are limits of the free machine and not errors of the program: two kills by the system when MICA's model building used up the RAM, and one run that hit the 2-hour limit close to the end of its model building (the last gap of the last chain). They count as failures all the same, because the user who runs MICA on this machine does not get a model. Of the 17 models, 3 (22FX, 9WQ6 and 9V4D) needed a second attempt after a GPU out-of-memory failure of the first one (Section 4.4).

6.2 Accuracy of the models that were built

Table 4 and Figure 1 show the accuracy of each method on its own set of models; the sets differ in size, so the rows are not directly comparable. The median TM-score of MICA is 0.94 (interquartile range 0.91–0.98; mean 0.94, 95 % CI 0.91–0.96), and 15 of its 17 models reach 0.90 or more (the lowest is 0.80). EModelX(+AF) has the same median and mean (0.94, 0.94). EMProt is higher (median 0.98, mean 0.96). E3-CryoFold is lower (0.91, 0.86). ModelAngelo has a median of 0.91 but a mean of only 0.79, because 3 of its models are below 0.5 (9WQ6, 9VBD, 9WTX, all at resolutions above 3.0 Å). CryoAtom has a median of 0.98 and a mean of 0.89; 11 of its 16 models reach 0.90 or more and the lowest is 0.53. Its TM-score has the strongest rank correlation with the resolution of

Table 3. Completion. *Model scored*: the run ended with a model file that was scored. *Failed*: crash, kill by the system or timeout. The last two columns divide by the 20 entries and by the entries on which the method was run (all 20).

Method	Entries	Model scored	Failed	No usable model	Not run	Completion, of 20 (%)	of attempted (%)
MICA	20	17	3	0	0	85	85
ModelAngelo	20	19	1	0	0	95	95
EModelX(+AF)	20	18	2	0	0	90	90
EMProt	20	19	1	0	0	95	95
E3-CryoFold	20	15	5	0	0	75	75
CryoAtom	20	16	4	0	0	80	80
CryoZeta	20	11	6	0	3	55	65

Table 4. TM-score and three other measures of the scored models of each method (all entries). Medians for the Cα match, coverage and Cα quality; the other measures are in Table A12. n is the number of scored models.

Method	n	TM-score, median (IQR)	TM-score, mean [95% CI]	Cα match	Coverage	Cα quality
MICA	17	0.94 (0.91–0.98)	0.94 [0.91, 0.96]	94.9	1.02	96.0
ModelAngelo	19	0.91 (0.67–0.99)	0.79 [0.68, 0.90]	91.1	1.01	96.7
EModelX(+AF)	18	0.94 (0.91–0.98)	0.94 [0.91, 0.96]	94.1	1.01	94.7
EMProt	19	0.98 (0.96–0.99)	0.96 [0.92, 0.98]	57.4	1.45	98.2
E3-CryoFold	15	0.91 (0.77–0.97)	0.86 [0.79, 0.93]	80.9	1.03	92.0
CryoAtom	16	0.98 (0.84–1.00)	0.89 [0.81, 0.96]	76.7	1.16	99.2
CryoZeta	11	0.99 (0.98–0.99)	0.98 [0.97, 0.99]	84.3	1.17	98.8

all methods (Section 6.3). CryoZeta has a median of 0.99 and a mean of 0.98 over its 11 models, of which 11 reach 0.90 or more (the lowest is 0.94); these models belong to the entries that it finished, so its row is the least comparable of the table (Section 6.3).

6.3 Paired comparison with MICA

Table 5 and Figure 2 compare each method with MICA on the entries where both built a model (difference = method minus MICA).

- **EMProt** has a higher TM-score than MICA on 16 of 17 entries; the mean difference is 0.04 (95 % CI 0.02 to 0.06), the median difference 0.02, the Wilcoxon p is <0.001 (Holm <0.001; paired t-test, Holm: 0.033). The difference is small and consistent: it is positive in both strata (0.05 up to 3.0 Å, 0.03 above) and EMProt is higher on 9 of the 9 entries above 3.0 Å.
- **EModelX(+AF)** is not different from MICA: mean difference 0.00 (-0.02 to 0.03), higher on 9 and lower on 8 of 17 entries, Wilcoxon Holm $p = 1.000$.
- **E3-CryoFold** is lower than MICA: -0.08 (-0.14 to -0.03) over 15 entries, lower on 13 of them; Wilcoxon Holm $p = 0.034$, but the t-test with Holm correction gives 0.089.
- **ModelAngelo** has a mean difference of -0.15 (-0.28 to -0.03) but a median difference of 0.00 (higher on 7, lower on 10 of 17 entries); the Wilcoxon Holm p is 0.621 and the t-test Holm p is 0.114. The mean is carried by the entries above 3.0 Å: up to 3.0 Å the mean difference is 0.02 (-0.06 to 0.09, $n = 8$); above 3.0 Å it is -0.30 (-0.48 to -0.13, $n = 9$), with ModelAngelo lower on 8 of them and a Wilcoxon Holm p of 0.098 (0.055 for the t-test).
- **CryoAtom** (added after the first version) is not different from MICA over all entries: mean difference -0.06 (-0.15 to 0.02), median difference 0.00, higher on 9 and lower on 5 of 14 entries, Wilcoxon Holm $p = 1.000$ (t-test: 0.392). Up to 3.0 Å the mean difference is 0.03 (-0.03 to 0.09, $n = 7$); above 3.0 Å it is -0.15 (-0.27 to -0.01, $n = 7$), with CryoAtom lower on 4 of them; this is not clear after the correction (Wilcoxon Holm $p = 0.438$, t-test 0.252). The 14 pairs leave out six entries: the three without a MICA model (26DK, 9VI4, 9OC0) and the other three on which CryoAtom ran out of GPU memory (13BD, 9VBD, 9Z24).
- **CryoZeta** (added after the first version) has a higher TM-score than MICA on 10 of the 11

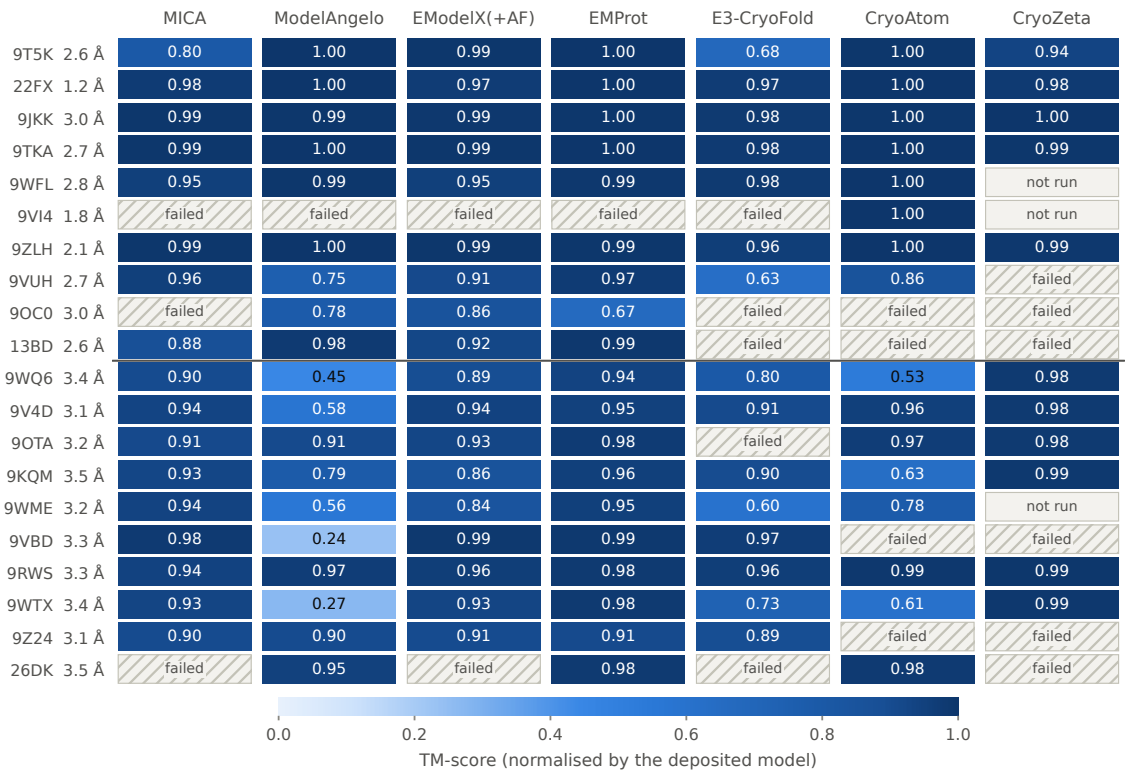


Figure 1. TM-score of every method on every entry (the primary measure, normalised by the deposited model). Entries are ordered by stratum, then by the seeded order of the selection; hatched cells are failed runs. The line separates the two resolution strata.

entries where both built a model and a lower one on 1: mean difference 0.05 (0.02 to 0.07), median difference 0.05, Wilcoxon Holm $p = 0.034$ (t-test: 0.033). Up to 3.0 Å the mean difference is 0.03 (-0.00 to 0.08, $n = 5$); above 3.0 Å it is 0.06 (0.05 to 0.07, $n = 6$), with CryoZeta higher on 6 of them (Wilcoxon Holm $p = 0.125$, t-test <0.001). The one entry where CryoZeta is lower is 9ZLH, by less than 0.01. Up to 3.0 Å the mean comes from one entry, 9T5K, where MICA reaches 0.80; on the other four the two methods differ by less than 0.01. The pairs are the entries that CryoZeta finished in the free GPU time; the 6 failures and the 3 entries not run are not in them, so the comparison holds for these entries and not for the twenty.

The rank correlation of the TM-score with the resolution is weak for MICA (Spearman $\rho = -0.25$, $p = 0.325$) and stronger for ModelAngelo ($\rho = -0.66$, $p = 0.002$), EMProt (-0.53, 0.018), EModelX(+AF) (-0.48, 0.044) and above all CryoAtom (-0.79, <0.001); the TM-score of CryoZeta, whose lowest value is 0.94, shows no relation to it (0.11, 0.750, $n = 11$); the correlations of the TM-score with the number of residues are all weak (Table A16, Appendix).

6.4 What the other measures say

The ranking by TM-score is not an artefact of fragmentation or of extra copies. ModelAngelo writes its models as several chains; US-align's multi-chain mode counts one fragment per deposited chain, so its TM-score mixes accuracy and continuity. With the fragment-agnostic TM-score (Table A14) the difference between ModelAngelo and MICA shrinks to -0.07 (-0.14 to -0.00; Wilcoxon Holm $p = 0.487$), EModelX(+AF) stays equal (0.00), EMProt stays higher (0.03, Holm $p = 0.010$) and E3-CryoFold lower (-0.05, Holm $p = 0.010$); CryoAtom is not different from MICA on this score (0.02, 0.00 to 0.06; Holm $p = 0.148$) and CryoZeta stays higher (0.04, 0.02 to 0.06; Holm $p = 0.020$). The Cα match (precision) is lowest for EMProt (median 57.4 against 94.9 for MICA) because EMProt builds 1.45 times the deposited number of residues (median; up to 25.11 times), that is, every copy it finds in the map; the same holds for ModelAngelo in a few entries (coverage up to 23.85) and for CryoAtom (median Cα match 76.7, coverage up to 59.91, that is, many more

Table 5. Paired comparison of the TM-score with MICA on the entries where both methods built a model (method minus MICA; 95 % bootstrap CI of the mean difference; two-sided Wilcoxon signed-rank test and paired *t*-test, both with Holm correction over the six methods; counts of entries where the method is higher, lower or equal).

Method	Pairs	Mean difference [95% CI]	Median diff.	Wilcoxon p	Holm p	t-test Holm p	higher / lower / equal
All entries							
ModelAngelo	17	−0.15 [−0.28, −0.03]	0.00	0.207	0.621	0.114	7 / 10 / 0
EModelX(+AF)	17	0.00 [−0.02, 0.03]	0.00	0.818	1.000	0.827	9 / 8 / 0
EMProt	17	0.04 [0.02, 0.06]	0.02	<0.001	<0.001	0.033	16 / 1 / 0
E3-CryoFold	15	−0.08 [−0.14, −0.03]	−0.03	0.007	0.034	0.089	2 / 13 / 0
CryoAtom	14	−0.06 [−0.15, 0.02]	0.00	0.761	1.000	0.392	9 / 5 / 0
CryoZeta	11	0.05 [0.02, 0.07]	0.05	0.007	0.034	0.033	10 / 1 / 0
Resolution ≤ 3.0 Å							
ModelAngelo	8	0.02 [−0.06, 0.09]	0.01	0.250	0.875	1.000	6 / 2 / 0
EModelX(+AF)	8	0.02 [−0.01, 0.08]	0.00	1.000	1.000	1.000	3 / 5 / 0
EMProt	8	0.05 [0.01, 0.10]	0.02	0.016	0.094	0.532	7 / 1 / 0
E3-CryoFold	7	−0.07 [−0.16, −0.00]	−0.01	0.109	0.547	0.944	1 / 6 / 0
CryoAtom	7	0.03 [−0.03, 0.09]	0.00	0.219	0.875	1.000	6 / 1 / 0
CryoZeta	5	0.03 [−0.00, 0.08]	0.00	0.438	0.875	1.000	4 / 1 / 0
Resolution > 3.0 to 4.0 Å							
ModelAngelo	9	−0.30 [−0.48, −0.13]	−0.36	0.020	0.098	0.055	1 / 8 / 0
EModelX(+AF)	9	−0.01 [−0.04, 0.01]	0.00	1.000	1.000	0.317	6 / 3 / 0
EMProt	9	0.03 [0.02, 0.04]	0.03	0.004	0.023	0.014	9 / 0 / 0
E3-CryoFold	8	−0.09 [−0.17, −0.02]	−0.03	0.039	0.125	0.252	1 / 7 / 0
CryoAtom	7	−0.15 [−0.27, −0.01]	−0.16	0.219	0.438	0.252	3 / 4 / 0
CryoZeta	6	0.06 [0.05, 0.07]	0.06	0.031	0.125	<0.001	6 / 0 / 0

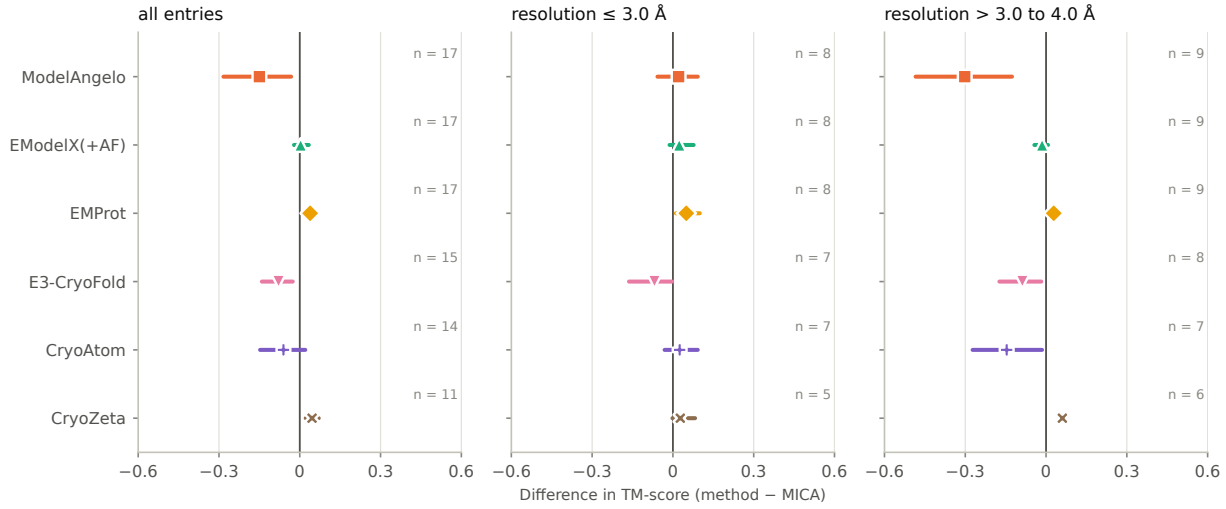


Figure 2. Difference in TM-score between each method and MICA (mean and 95 % bootstrap CI), for all entries and for each resolution stratum; positive values favour the other method.

residues than the deposit); CryoZeta also builds more residues than the deposit (median coverage 1.17, up to 1.58; median Cα match 84.3). MICA builds about the deposited number of residues (median coverage 1.02) because its input is one AF3 prediction per unique chain; only in 13BD did it build clearly more than the deposit (coverage 4.76; the next highest is 1.18). The Cα quality score, which does not punish extra copies, gives 96.0 for MICA, 96.7 for ModelAngelo, 94.7 for EModelX(+AF), 98.2 for EMProt 92.0 for E3-CryoFold, 99.2 for CryoAtom and 98.8 for CryoZeta (medians, %). The median sequence match of MICA is 98.5 %, and its median RMSD over the aligned residues is 1.10 Å for 409 aligned residues, against 0.63 Å for 306 for ModelAngelo, whose models align over fewer residues, so RMSDs are not comparable across methods (all measures: Table A12, Figure A1).

6.5 Failures scored as zero

If a failed run counts as zero on every measure (Table A9), the mean TM-score over all 20 entries is 0.80 for MICA (95 % CI 0.64–0.93), 0.76 for ModelAngelo, 0.84 for EModelX(+AF), 0.91 for EMProt, 0.65 for E3-CryoFold and 0.71 for CryoAtom. For CryoZeta the mean is taken over the 17 entries on which it ran, its 6 failures counted as zero (the entries not run are not failures and are left out): 0.64 (95 % CI 0.40–0.87); the second variant of Table A9 counts the entries not run as zero as well. On this footing neither ModelAngelo, EModelX(+AF), CryoAtom nor CryoZeta differs from MICA: the mean differences are −0.04, 0.05, −0.08 and −0.19 (Holm p = 1.000, 1.000, 1.000 and 1.000). For CryoZeta the difference is taken over the 17 entries on which it ran, with the results of MICA on the same entries; it is negative because CryoZeta failed on 9Z24, 13BD, 9VBD and 9VUH, where MICA built a model. The failures of CryoAtom and CryoZeta are limits of the 15 GB GPU, of the RAM and of the run limit and not errors of the programs, as those of MICA are limits of the free machine. EMProt remains higher (0.12; Holm p <0.001) and E3-CryoFold lower (−0.15; Holm p = 0.008). If the 3 reruns counted as failures as well, MICA would have 14 models with a mean TM-score of 0.94, and a mean of 0.66 over all 20 entries.

6.6 Docking and its effect on MICA

MICA's own docking could not be run on a free machine (Section 2.2), so the placements of the AF3 domains in the map are coarse and unverified. Pass 3 docked 46 of 59 domains (Table A6); 14 entries are fully docked, 5 partly and 1 not at all.

Docked against no docked input. On the 8 entries that ran with and without docked input (all fully docked), the TM-score is 0.953 with and 0.936 without docked input; the mean difference is 0.017 (95 % CI 0.002 to 0.037), Wilcoxon p = 0.039, higher with docked input on 6 and lower on 2 entries (Table A10). The differences are small (the largest are 9KQM and 9VUH), but they go in the expected direction, which is weak evidence that the coarse placements carry information. Without docked input MICA still uses the AF3 structures when it builds the chains, so this is not a comparison with MICA without AlphaFold.

By docking mode. The 13 models of fully docked entries have a mean TM-score of 0.95 (range 0.90–0.99), the 4 models of partly docked entries 0.89 (0.80–0.98); the three lowest TM-scores of MICA are those of 9T5K, 13BD and 9Z24, and 3 of these entries are partly docked. This is a description and not a test, because the entries also differ in size and resolution, but it points to the same side: where the free-compute docking left a domain unplaced, MICA was less accurate, so the docking deviation more probably understates than overstates MICA. The initial Cα model that MICA's network writes before the chains are built from the AF3 structures has a median TM-score of 0.82, against 0.94 for the final model (Table A15); a large part of MICA's accuracy on these maps comes from the step that uses the AF3 structures (the AF3 predictions themselves were not scored).

6.7 Novelty and run time

Only 3 entries have a chain at 30 % identity or less to any pre-2026 PDB chain (9TKA, 9VBD, 26DK), and MICA failed on one of them, so the planned low-identity analysis has 2 pairs and is not tested; the TM-scores on these entries are in Table A11. Over all entries the TM-score of MICA is not related to the identity to older entries (Spearman ρ = 0.02, p = 0.940), and no method shows a relation with p below 0.05 (smallest p of the seven methods: 0.080; Table A16).

Run times are only indicative (Table A17, Figure A4). The median time of MICA is 82 min per entry (range 33 to 558; 40.0 h in total for programs 1 to 3 including docking), against 20 min for ModelAngelo, 7 for EModelX(+AF), 14 for EMProt, 3 for E3-CryoFold and 11 for CryoAtom (range 2 to 395) and 90 for CryoZeta (range 6 to 360, failed runs included; the time of CryoZeta includes the search for the alignments on the ColabFold server). The baselines were timed while a second program used the other GPU, MICA's program 3 ran one entry at a time, and most of MICA's time

on a large map goes into model building on one CPU core. The whole benchmark, including every failed attempt and the first two docking passes, used 85.2 h of GPU sessions and 69.2 h of CPU sessions (35 sessions, Table A5).

7 Discussion and limitations

7.1 What the results show

On maps released in 2026 and within the size range of this benchmark, MICA gives accurate models when it completes: the median TM-score is 0.94, and 15 of its 17 models reach 0.90 or more. With the same AF3 predictions, EModelX(+AF) is indistinguishable from it (mean difference 0.00); E3-CryoFold, which has no AF3 input, is less accurate (-0.08) and fails more often (5 of 20 entries). ModelAngelo, which also has no AF3 input, matches MICA on the maps up to 3.0 Å (0.02) and is lower above 3.0 Å (-0.30); part of this gap is an effect of how the TM-score treats fragments, because over all entries the mean difference shrinks from -0.15 to -0.07 with the fragment-agnostic score (Section 6.4). CryoAtom, which has no AF3 input either, is not different from MICA over the 14 entries where both built a model (-0.06): its difference is 0.03 up to 3.0 Å and -0.15 above, and its TM-score falls with the resolution more than that of any other method (Section 6.3). It built models for 9VI4 and 26DK, where MICA ran out of RAM, but ran out of GPU memory on 4 other entries. CryoZeta, which has no AF3 input either but reads an alignment of every chain, is higher than MICA on the 11 entries where both built a model (0.05); it ran to the end on only 11 of the 20 entries (6 failures, 3 not run), and its median TM-score there is 0.99. The comparison covers the entries that it finished and not a random sample, and whether its lead holds on the entries where it failed or was not run is not answered here. Its advantage over MICA is larger above 3.0 Å (0.06, higher on 6 of 6 entries) than up to 3.0 Å (0.03, a mean that comes from one entry, 9T5K; on the other four MICA is already close to 1), and its TM-score shows no relation to the resolution (0.11), unlike that of CryoAtom or ModelAngelo; this fits a method that builds from the sequence and an alignment as well as from the map, but this benchmark did not test the reason. EMProt, which also uses the AF3 models but builds from the map first, is higher than MICA by a small and consistent margin (0.04); it appeared after MICA, which may explain part of the gap, but this benchmark cannot separate the reasons. After the Holm correction the differences to EMProt (Wilcoxon <0.001, t-test 0.033) and to CryoZeta (0.034 and 0.033, on 11 entries) are clear on both tests; E3-CryoFold is lower on the Wilcoxon test (0.034) but not on the t-test (0.089), and ModelAngelo above 3.0 Å is borderline (0.098 and 0.055; 0.059 and 0.041 in the first version, before the added methods enlarged the family of the correction). The other differences, CryoAtom's above 3.0 Å included (0.438 and 0.252), are within the noise of 17 entries.

The step that uses the AF3 structures lifts the median TM-score from 0.82 (the Cα model of the network) to 0.94 (Table A15); the AF3 predictions were not scored on their own, so how much of the result is the prior and how much is the map is not separated here. The prior is good: the median over the predictions of the mean pLDDT is 87.0, and for 13 of the 20 entries a chain at 95 % identity or more to an older PDB entry exists, which AF3 (whose training data end in 2021; Abramson et al., 2024) may have seen. The benchmark therefore measures how well a method turns a good prior and a new map into a model; the 3 entries with no relative in older PDB entries (9TKA, 9VBD, 26DK) are too few to say how MICA behaves without that prior (MICA failed on one of them; its scores on the others are in Table A11).

7.2 Limitations

1. **Sample and range.** There are 20 entries, 17 MICA models and at most 17 pairs per comparison (11 for CryoZeta), all single-particle, protein-only maps of up to 682 residues and three unique chains (the test maps of the MICA paper go up to several thousand residues). Differences of a few hundredths of TM-score cannot be resolved. Nothing here says how the methods behave on large complexes, where the memory and time limits of the free machine, which already

stopped 2 MICA runs for lack of RAM and 1 at its time limit here, would matter even more.

2. **Docking.** MICA's own docking (Phenix molecular replacement without time limit) could not run on a free machine. The search here is a coarse Fourier search at 6 or 10 Å with a time limit; 5 entries are partly docked and 1 not at all, and the placements were not checked against the deposited models. The indirect evidence (Section 6.6) suggests that this understates MICA, but it rests on 8 entries and on a descriptive split.
3. **No real-space refinement.** MICA's last step stopped with a parameter error in Phenix 2.2.1-6174, for every entry. The scored models are MICA's models before refinement. I did not refine the outputs of the other methods either, but their own pipelines may include refinement-like steps, so the comparison is not strictly symmetric; the absolute numbers are not those of the authors' full pipeline, and the effect on all-atom quality was not measured.
4. **Memory patch and reruns.** The network of MICA predicts every window on its own, as MICA does for maps with 200 windows or fewer, so that the larger maps fit into the 15 GB of the GPU; MICA's own setting (batches of eight windows) was not compared with it, and the setting is meant to change memory use only. The 3 models of 22FX, 9WQ6 and 9V4D come from reruns after a first failure with MICA's default batching, an exception to the one-run rule that is reported.
5. **Failures depend on the machine.** Of the 22 runs that ended without a model, 9 were kills by the system (probably for lack of RAM), 5 reached a run limit (1 of MICA, 1 of ModelAngelo and 3 of CryoZeta), 3 were crashes of E3-CryoFold (exit code 1; entries 13BD, 9OC0 and 9OTA), 4 were CUDA out-of-memory errors of CryoAtom (entries 13BD, 9OC0, 9VBD and 9Z24) and CryoZeta ran out of GPU memory on 13BD. All happened on a machine with 31 GB of RAM, a 15 GB GPU and fixed run limits; a larger machine would probably have completed the kills and the CryoAtom and CryoZeta runs that ran out of memory, and perhaps the runs that reached a limit, but not the crashes of E3-CryoFold. Scoring failures as zero therefore describes this machine and the programs together.
6. **One run per entry.** Each method ran once per entry, with one AF3 prediction (one random seed, server defaults) per chain; the variation between AF3 seeds and between repeated runs was not measured. Run times come from shared free machines and are indicative.
7. **Reference models and measures.** The deposited models are not ground truth: they contain errors and may have been built with tools such as ModelAngelo or from AF predictions, which could favour similar methods. The maps often hold more copies than the deposit, so methods that build every copy have a low Cα match by construction; US-align's TM-score counts one fragment per chain. The conclusions rest on the TM-score and the Cα quality score and are checked with the fragment-agnostic score.
8. **Protocol choices.** EModelX(+AF) was run with the AF3 predictions as templates, not in its default AlphaFold mode, and E3-CryoFold only in its `pre_align` protocol; ModelAngelo had no AlphaFold input by design. These choices were fixed before the runs. CryoAtom was added after the first version with a run limit of 10 hours, against 3 hours for the other baselines; this favours it, because 2 of its models (26DK (231 min) and 9VI4 (395 min)) took longer than 3 hours and would have been failures under the limit of the others; the same holds for CryoZeta with 6 hours (2 models: 9JKK (224 min) and 9OTA (196 min)). The literature search could not use forward citations of MICA.
9. **CryoZeta: a subset, a smaller GPU, another input.** CryoZeta ran on 17 of the 20 entries and has a model for 11; it failed on 13BD, 26DK, 9OC0, 9VBD, 9VUH and 9Z24 and was not run on 9VI4, 9WFL and 9WME. The entries it finished are not a random sample, so its comparison with MICA is one on those entries, with 11 pairs, and the failures and the entries not run may be the entries on which it would be less accurate or slower. Its README asks for 32 GB of GPU memory and the free machine has 15 GB: the out-of-memory failures and part of the run time are limits of that machine, as are the kills for lack of RAM in the detection step of 26DK and 9OC0 and the run limit of 6 hours (9Z24, 9VBD and 9VUH; 9WFL and 9WME, cut after 4 to 5 hours in each of their last sessions, are probably long runs of the same kind). Its alignments

come from the public ColabFold server, without pairing of the chains of a complex, and may differ from those of its authors. I did not find the date up to which its weights were trained (the README does not say; the preprint appeared in February 2026), so entries released in early 2026 may have been in its training data, which is a risk that the other methods, whose papers were online before 2026, do not carry in this form.

10. **Selection.** The map–model correlation rule (CC_{mask} of at least 0.70) removed 6 entries, all in the stratum above 3.0 Å, and 2 more could not be computed; the stratum above 3.0 Å therefore holds maps that are well explained by their models. The seeded order favours common specimens to the degree that the pool does.

8 Conclusions

1. On 20 maps released in 2026, MICA built an accurate model (median TM-score 0.94) for 17 entries and did not finish on 3: two runs were killed by the system for lack of RAM and one reached its time limit, all on a free 31 GB machine.
2. Where both methods built a model (differences are method minus MICA), EModelX(+AF) did not differ from MICA with the same AF3 predictions (0.00), EMProt was slightly higher (0.04; Holm $p < 0.001$), E3-CryoFold was lower (-0.08; Holm $p = 0.034$ for the Wilcoxon test, 0.089 for the t-test), and ModelAngelo was lower on the maps above 3.0 Å (-0.30; Holm $p = 0.098$ and 0.055) but not up to 3.0 Å (0.02); CryoAtom, added after the first version, did not differ (-0.06; Holm $p = 1.000$), and CryoZeta, added after the first version and run on 17 entries, was higher on the 11 entries where both built a model (0.05; Holm $p = 0.034$ for the Wilcoxon test, 0.033 for the t-test). Only the differences to EMProt and to CryoZeta are clear on both tests.
3. Counting every failure as zero, the mean TM-score over all 20 entries is 0.80 for MICA, 0.76 for ModelAngelo, 0.84 for EModelX(+AF), 0.91 for EMProt, 0.65 for E3-CryoFold and 0.71 for CryoAtom (for CryoZeta 0.64 over the 17 entries on which it ran); MICA does not differ from ModelAngelo, EModelX(+AF), CryoAtom or CryoZeta on this footing, is below EMProt and above E3-CryoFold.
4. CryoZeta, which asks for a GPU of 32 GB, built accurate models where it ran (median TM-score 0.99, lowest of the 11 models 0.94) but finished only 11 of the 20 entries on the free 15 GB machine (6 failures, 3 not run); whether it keeps its lead over MICA on the entries where it failed or was not run, and on a larger GPU, is the open question of this part of the benchmark.
5. The step of MICA that uses the AF3 structures raises the median TM-score from 0.82 (the network's own Cα model) to 0.94. Docked input helped slightly on the 8 entries that could be tested (mean difference 0.017).
6. The results hold for the pipeline as I could run it: coarse docking, no real-space refinement, a one-window memory patch, one run per entry. What would tighten them: MICA's own docking on a large-memory machine, its refinement with a Phenix version that accepts its parameter file, a check of the docked placements against the deposited models, repeated AF3 seeds and larger entries.

9 Reproducibility and statement on assistance

Repository. https://github.com/Zohaib-Bioinfo/mica-benchmark holds the specification (`docs/SPEC.md`) and the project log with every decision, error and change (`LOG.md`); the frozen entry list and the selection record (`data/`); the notebooks as run, their generators and the analysis scripts with their tests (`scripts/`); the environment files (`env/`) and the pinned methods table (`methods/`); the unpacked text outputs of every session and the scores of every model (`results/raw/`); and this report (`report/`).

Regenerating the report. One script turns the scores and the status tables into the statistics (`analyze_results.py`), one draws the figures (`make_figures.py`), one writes the tables and the

numbers of the text (`make_report_tables.py`) and one compiles the PDF (`build_report.py`), which stops if a number, a reference or a citation is missing. `scripts/regenerate.sh` runs the four in order (`--check`: compare the tables only); see the `README.md`.

What is not in the repository. The AF3 predictions (the terms of AlphaFold Server), the Phenix installer and the coordinate files of the models; the AF3 job list, the checks and the file hashes are public, so that the inputs can be recreated. Running the notebooks again needs a Kaggle account with GPU quota, the private AF3 dataset and a Phenix download login.

Statement on AI assistance. I did this project with an AI assistant, Claude (Anthropic), and the work was divided as follows. *My part:* I took the task from Prof. Cheng, chose the free-compute plan and locked the specification (`docs/SPEC.md`: the methods, the entry filters and the selection rule, the metrics, the statistics and the handling of failed runs) on 10 October 2026, before any method was run; I made the AF3 predictions, obtained the Phenix academic licence, ran every notebook that produced a result on my own Kaggle and Colab accounts, uploaded the outputs of each session and read this report in full. *The assistant's part:* it wrote the notebooks, the scripts and their tests, the project log and the text of this report, working from the specification and from the outputs that I uploaded; it proposed the plan for each stage and the technical decisions, which I approved. *Checks:* every result in the report is computed from the raw outputs by the scripts of the repository and inserted automatically (the few figures quoted from logs are marked as such, Section 4), and every decision, error and change, including the assistant's own mistakes (for example a Phenix parameter in the second docking pass that this Phenix version rejected), is dated in `LOG.md`. I am responsible for what this report says.

Acknowledgements. MICA, ModelAngelo, EModelX, EMProt, E3-CryoFold, CryoAtom and CryoZeta are the work of their authors; I used their public code and weights as released. Compute came from the free tiers of Kaggle and Google Colab.

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A Tables and figures that the text refers to

This appendix holds the longer tables and the further figures. Every one of them is written by a script of the repository from the unpacked session outputs in `results/raw/` (Section 9); the tables are `report/generated/tab_*.tex` and the figures `report/figures/`. Tables and figures of the appendix are numbered A1, A2, ...

A.1 Methods and entries

Table A1 lists every method that the screen of the newer methods considered, Table A2 the filters that led to the pool of candidates, Table A3 the twenty entries and Table A4 the pinned versions.

Table A1. Screen of newer methods (spec decision 2). *Included*: *baseline*, the method under test or one of the two baselines of its paper; *passed*, passed the screen (CryoAtom was then dropped by the first scope cut and added after the first version, Sections 2.4 and 2.5); *reserve*, kept in reserve (CryoZeta was added from the reserve after the first version, Section 2.5; the other reserve was not used); *no*, excluded for the reason given. The reasons are the notes written at the time of the search (to 11 October 2026).

Method	Year	Included	Reason
MICA	2025	baseline	Method under test.
ModelAngelo	2024	baseline	One of the two methods tested in the MICA paper.
EModelX(+AF)	2024	baseline	The other method tested in the MICA paper.
CryoAtom	2025	passed	Newer than both baselines; deep learning; map + sequence to atomic model; public code and weights (MIT per README; the paper states no licence); defaults in one documented command; fits 16 GB on paper. Formerly CryFold. The CryoAtom2 preprint (proteins and nucleic acids) reports nucleic-acid results in its abstract; whether protein-only accuracy changed from v1 is not stated.
EMProt	2025	passed	Newer than both baselines; deep learning; map + sequence to atomic model; accepts per-chain predicted models, so it can take the same AF3 inputs as MICA; public code and weights; fits 16 GB on paper. Licence wording differs: README says MIT, the paper says free for academic or noncommercial users. Read the LICENSE file before release.
E3-CryoFold	2025	passed	Newer than both baselines; deep learning; map + sequence to atomic model; public code and weights (MIT per README; the paper states no licence); fits 16 GB on paper. Defaults to be taken verbatim from the README example. First excluded by mistake on an inferred link to EModelX; corrected 2026-10-11 after reading its own paper.
EM3DFold	2026	reserve	First reserve. Newer, deep learning, map + sequence to atomic model (protein-only mode available), public code and downloadable weights, fits 16 GB on paper; licence not stated. A preprint ('in submission'), so under the tie-break the three peer-reviewed methods keep their places. From the same group as EMProt; the README does not say whether it supersedes EMProt. Training-data cutoff not read: check it before use, because the benchmark relies on the 2026 entries being unseen. Recheck on 2026-10-15 for a release tag, a licence and journal status.
CryoZeta	2026	reserve	Newer, deep learning, public code and weights, but fails the 16 GB rule on paper (README: 32 GB or more) and needs MSAs from an outside tool. Second reserve, after EM3DFold: used only if EM3DFold has already replaced a method or cannot be run, and only after one pilot on the smallest entry shows it fits 16 GB.

Method	Year	Included	Reason
CryoACE	2026	no	Fails the 16 GB rule (~38 GB) and is not a map-plus-sequence builder with documented defaults: it needs a rough initial model aligned to each map plus resolution and threshold settings. Its paper compares against ModelAngelo, CryoAtom, E3-CryoFold, Boltz-1 and CryoBoltz.
CryoBoltz	2025	no	Guided sampling of a Boltz model toward the map, with a pre-aligned starting model and per-map settings, not a map-plus-sequence builder with documented defaults. Also over 16 GB on the third-party figure.
CryoForge	2026	no	A post-builder correction layer that repairs another builder's model; it is not a map-plus-sequence builder. No code or weights stated.
CryoNet.Discovery	2026	no	Identifies known structures by matching map and structure embeddings (retrieval), so it does not build a model. No code or weights stated. Compared with ModelAngelo, cryoID and DomainFit.
CoCoFold	2026	no	Not a map-based builder (the input is raw particle images) and peak GPU memory is far above 16 GB. Its paper compares against DiffModeler, DeepMainmast, EModelX, MICA and ModelAngelo.
Cryo2Struct	2024	no	Not newer: published before EModelX (Nat. Commun. 15, 8808, same volume). Earlier method from the Cheng lab (Giri and Cheng); its evaluation code is checked in Phase 1 for the metric definitions.
DeepMainmast	–	no	Not newer: first published online in 2023, before the ModelAngelo paper (2024).
EMBuild	2022	no	Not newer (2022).
DiffModeler	2024	no	Built for low-resolution maps; outside the <=4.0 A test range.
DMcloud	2025	no	Built for medium- to low-resolution maps; outside the <=4.0 A test range.
DeepTracer (family)	–	no	Earlier family of methods; no 2025-2026 release found.
CryoREAD	–	no	Models DNA and RNA only; the benchmark is protein-only.
SMARTFold	2023	no	Not newer: 2023 preprint.
CryoNet.Refine	2026	no	Refines an existing model; does not build one from a map and sequence.
Cryosearch	2026	no	Assembles components into complexes rather than building from a map and sequence; no public code found.
CryoSampler	2026	no	Models conformational ensembles; no public code found.
Cryformer	–	no	Listed as its own entry in a bioRxiv review of Dec 2025 (10.64898/2025.12.28.696775; map + ESM-2 embeddings), but the name matches the encoder module of the CryFold/CryoAtom network (Cry-Net), and no separate paper or code was found.
SEGEM++	–	no	Listed in the Dec 2025 review as using AlphaFold2 output; no paper or code found under this name.
Cryo2Struct2	–	no	Described in the Dec 2025 review as map + ESM embeddings with AlphaFold3 refining its output; no paper, code or weights found under this name. How it relates to MICA is not established.
CryoCodex	2026	no	Screened by title only: map post-processing, not model building.
EMAlign	2026	no	Screened by title only: aligns cryo-EM maps, does not build models.
HDOCK-Multimer	2026	no	Screened by title only: predicts large complexes by docking and assembly; the title names no map input.
Ligand-modelling paper	–	no	Screened by title only: models ligands, not protein chains.

Table A2. From the pool of cryo-EM entries released from 1 January to 12 October 2026 to the candidates. The map–model correlation rule and the clustering (Section 3) are applied to the 484 candidates of the last row.

Step	Entries left	Removed
Cryo-EM entries released in the window (RCSB search)	6 116	–
mmCIF file of at most 40 MB compressed (a larger file holds far more than 700 residues)	6 115	1
PDB model released inside the window	6 115	0
Single-particle reconstruction	5 700	415
Resolution at most 4.0 Å	5 219	481
Protein only (every polymer entity is polypeptide(L))	3 977	1 242
1 to 700 modeled residues in total	567	3 410
At most 3 unique chain sequences	548	19
At most 5% UNK residues	548	0
Exactly one EMDB map linked to the entry	485	63
EMDB map released inside the window (EMDB API)	484	1

Table A3. The twenty entries. *Residues*: modelled residues of the deposit. *Unique / all chains*: unique chain sequences and chains of the deposit. *CC_mask*: map–model correlation (Phenix `map_model_cc`, at the resolution of the entry). *Max. identity*: highest sequence identity of any chain to a chain of a PDB entry released before 2026 (MMseqs2; 0 = no hit). *AF3 pLDDT*: mean pLDDT of the AF3 predictions of the entry, weighted by residues. *Map*: size of the EMDB map file.

PDB	EMDB	Res. (Å)	Residues	Unique / all chains	CC_mask	Max. identity to older PDB	AF3 pLDDT	Map (MB)
Resolution ≤ 3.0 Å								
9T5K	55586	2.60	381	1 / 1	0.82	0.61	85	250
22FX	68251	1.24	173	1 / 1	0.74	1.00	97	75
9JKK	61564	3.00	530	1 / 1	0.84	1.00	85	66
9TKA	56022	2.70	247	1 / 1	0.76	0.00	88	182
9WFL	65930	2.75	682	2 / 2	0.84	1.00	91	66
9VI4	65077	1.80	516	1 / 1	0.87	0.98	98	1024
9ZLH	74403	2.14	206	1 / 1	0.85	1.00	92	66
9VUH	65363	2.70	634	3 / 3	0.74	1.00	77	128
9OC0	70305	2.97	512	2 / 4	0.83	1.00	84	333
13BD	76936	2.65	461	1 / 2	0.88	0.95	84	281
Resolution > 3.0 to 4.0 Å								
9WQ6	66160	3.40	261	1 / 1	0.76	1.00	84	128
9V4D	64777	3.07	276	2 / 2	0.82	0.50	71	54
9OTA	70828	3.20	534	1 / 2	0.85	1.00	86	69
9KQM	62507	3.50	403	1 / 1	0.79	1.00	76	66
9WME	66088	3.20	446	2 / 2	0.70	1.00	90	23
9VBD	64920	3.26	521	1 / 1	0.77	0.00	93	128
9RWS	54346	3.28	512	1 / 1	0.85	0.44	88	128
9WTX	66226	3.37	500	1 / 1	0.72	0.76	88	128
9Z24	73762	3.10	338	1 / 1	0.87	1.00	80	221
26DK	80558	3.50	191	1 / 1	0.74	0.00	97	16

Method	Year	Included	Reason
TomoSwin3D	–	no	Screened by title only: identifies and classifies macromolecules in cryo-ET tomograms, does not build models.

A.2 Sessions, docking and failures

Table A5 lists the sessions, Table A6 the docking of every entry in the three passes, Table A7 MICA's outcome by entry and Table A8 every failed run.

Table A4. Pinned versions of the methods and the tools, as recorded in the run information of the sessions.

Component	Commit or file (pinned)
MICA	`726d1bb14be04887a43b7f5aefcff0d843761d01`
ModelAngelo	`994945bdfa6e5368e0d62349a47792f4864eebc3`
EModelX(+AF)	`53713cf820d10d78b1ca6669ef197850cf907843`
EMProt	`9489d52e7fdc81c85ba82e386abcfa05bac2b9d1`
E3-CryoFold	`241cef48da83b96519e62ab02cccd9db96d8e68b`
CryoAtom	`e2a31f2b2ff21fae363490ac5f4a5e945513024c`
CryoZeta	`c544c6bbd0366951d8b4e0bc4c0da547836f7b8f`
Phenix	`Phenix-2.2.1-6174-Linux-x86_64.sh`
US-align	`746ad8a2a4dea9f317075cc482df0ecb5440bdea`

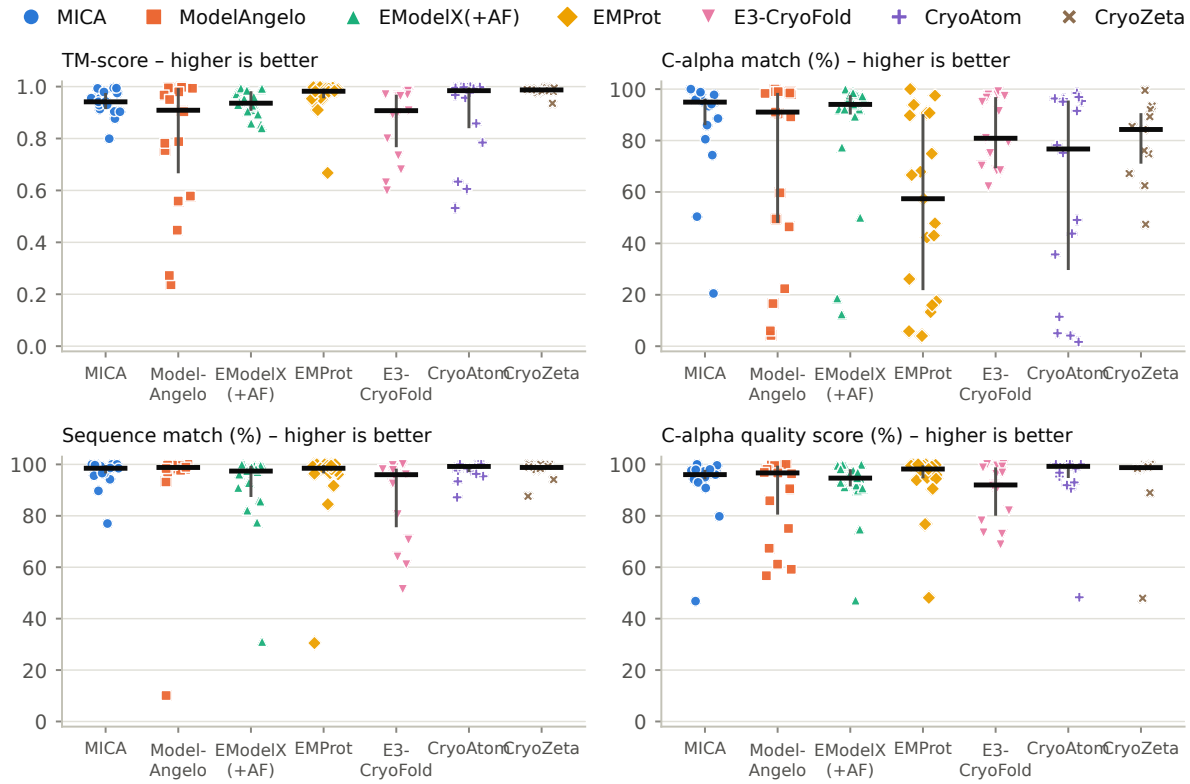


Figure A1. Four measures over the scored models of each method (one dot per entry; black bar: median; grey bar: interquartile range).

A.3 Further results

Tables A9 and A10 belong to Sections 6 (failures as zero) and 6.6 (docked input); the other tables give the TM-score of every method on every entry (Table A11), all measures (Tables A12, A13 and A14), the other output files of the methods (Table A15), the correlations (Table A16), the run times (Table A17) and the comparison with MICA without docked input (Table A18).

A.4 Further figures

The figures show the distributions of the measures (Figures A1 and A5), the pairs of TM-scores (Figure A2), the outcomes and the run times (Figures A3 and A4), and the checks with the fragment-agnostic score and the resolution (Figures A6, A7 and A8).

Table A5. The 35 Kaggle sessions (CPU sessions have no GPU). Status of the entries of a session: *ok*, finished with its output; *docked*, programs 1 and 2 of MICA finished and the docked state was saved for a GPU session; *failed*, ended without the output of its step; *deferred*, program 3 of MICA was switched off after two failures in a row and the entry waits; *interrupted*, cut by the end of the session; *killed_corun*, a baseline killed by the system while the other GPU was busy (it ran again alone if there was time, Section 4; 9VI4 of CryoZeta did not, and 9OC0 of CryoZeta was run again alone in the next session); *not run*, no work was started. The baseline sessions count runs (method × entry), the MICA sessions count entries, and the scoring sessions the models that they scored. The result of `mica_cpu_c` for 9VUH (pass 1) is not used: every MICA result comes from the pass-3 set-up. In `gpu_cryozeta_a` (CryoZeta, added after the first version) the set-up ended in an error before any entry was run: the program could not find two of its data files, which the notebook had not downloaded. Its rows *failed* are not runs of CryoZeta, are not in Table A8 and are not used in any analysis; the session is listed for its GPU time, the notebook was corrected and the run was made again in `gpu_cryozeta_b`, `gpu_cryozeta_c`, `gpu_cryozeta_d` and `gpu_cryozeta_e`. In these sessions the entries that were not started for lack of time are *not run*; 9WME was *interrupted* by the end of the session after 4.9 hours in the first one, 4.1 in the third and 4.7 in the fourth, and 9WFL after 4.4 and 4.7 hours in the last two; the map of 9ZLH could not be downloaded from the EMDB in the first one (the notebook now asks again after 2, 4 and 6 minutes). The first start of `gpu_cryozeta_d` stopped after 25 seconds, because the check of the internet at the start of the notebook counted one TLS time-out of the EBI server as a missing site; no program was started (the check now asks up to four times). `gpu_cryozeta_e` is the notebook of `gpu_cryozeta_d` started again with the list 9VUH, 9WFL, 9WME; 9VUH, which had reached the 6-hour limit in the third session, ran first and alone and reached it again. `scoring_cryozeta_d` and `scoring_cryozeta_e` stopped by themselves, because the sessions that they were to score had built no model. These three stopped sessions are listed for their time and are not used in any analysis.

Notebook	Started (UTC)	Minutes	GPU	Entries by status, or models scored
`gpu_batch1`	2026-10-23 05:35	521	yes	ok 64, failed 3, killed_corun 6, not run 7
`mica_cpu_a`	2026-10-24 06:34	417	no	failed 3, deferred 4
`gpu_batch2`	2026-10-24 06:44	410	yes	ok 1, failed 4, interrupted 1, not run 7
`mica_cpu_c`	2026-10-24 06:40	441	no	ok 1, failed 4, deferred 1
`mica_cpu_b`	2026-10-24 06:37	611	no	failed 5, deferred 2
`mica_dock2_a`	2026-10-25 16:17	262	no	docked 4, failed 1
`mica_dock2_d`	2026-10-25 16:23	284	no	docked 2, failed 3
`mica_dock2_b`	2026-10-25 16:19	377	no	failed 5
`mica_dock2_c`	2026-10-25 16:21	379	no	docked 1, failed 4
`gpu_batch3`	2026-10-25 16:30	432	yes	ok 6, failed 2
`mica_dock3_c`	2026-10-26 10:46	229	no	docked 5
`mica_dock3_a`	2026-10-26 10:42	272	no	docked 5
`mica_dock3_d`	2026-10-26 10:48	275	no	docked 5
`mica_dock3_b`	2026-10-26 10:44	459	no	docked 5
`scoring_base`	2026-10-27 02:08	26	no	127 models scored
`mica_gpu_nodock`	2026-10-27 02:05	105	yes	ok 8, failed 3, deferred 9
`mica_gpu`	2026-10-27 02:04	143	yes	ok 8, failed 3, deferred 9
`scoring_mica`	2026-10-27 10:15	14	no	24 models scored
`scoring_nodock`	2026-10-27 10:18	14	no	24 models scored
`mica_gpu2_b`	2026-10-27 16:38	190	yes	ok 6, failed 1
`mica_gpu2_a`	2026-10-27 16:34	195	yes	ok 3, interrupted 2 (cut by the time budget)
`scoring_mica2`	2026-10-28 05:45	17	no	27 models scored
`mica_gpu3`	2026-10-28 05:02	186	yes	failed 2
`gpu_cryoatom_a`	2026-10-31 17:40	527	yes	ok 16, failed 4
`scoring_cryoatom`	2026-11-01 10:06	18	no	32 models scored
`gpu_cryozeta_a`	2026-11-02 09:12	18	yes	failed 3, not run 17
`gpu_cryozeta_b`	2026-11-03 01:43	650	yes	ok 8, failed 1, interrupted 1, not run 10
`scoring_cryozeta_b`	2026-11-04 03:09	15	no	40 models scored
`gpu_cryozeta_c`	2026-11-04 03:06	435	yes	ok 3, failed 3, killed_corun 1, not run 5
`scoring_cryozeta_c`	2026-11-04 12:50	13	no	15 models scored
`gpu_cryozeta_d`	2026-11-07 03:56	0	yes	– (stopped by a check of the notebook)
`gpu_cryozeta_d`	2026-11-07 04:13	650	yes	failed 3, interrupted 2, killed_corun 1
`scoring_cryozeta_d`	2026-11-07 15:15	13	no	– (stopped by a check of the notebook)
`gpu_cryozeta_e`	2026-11-07 17:27	650	yes	failed 1, interrupted 2
`scoring_cryozeta_e`	2026-11-08 04:46	13	no	– (stopped by a check of the notebook)

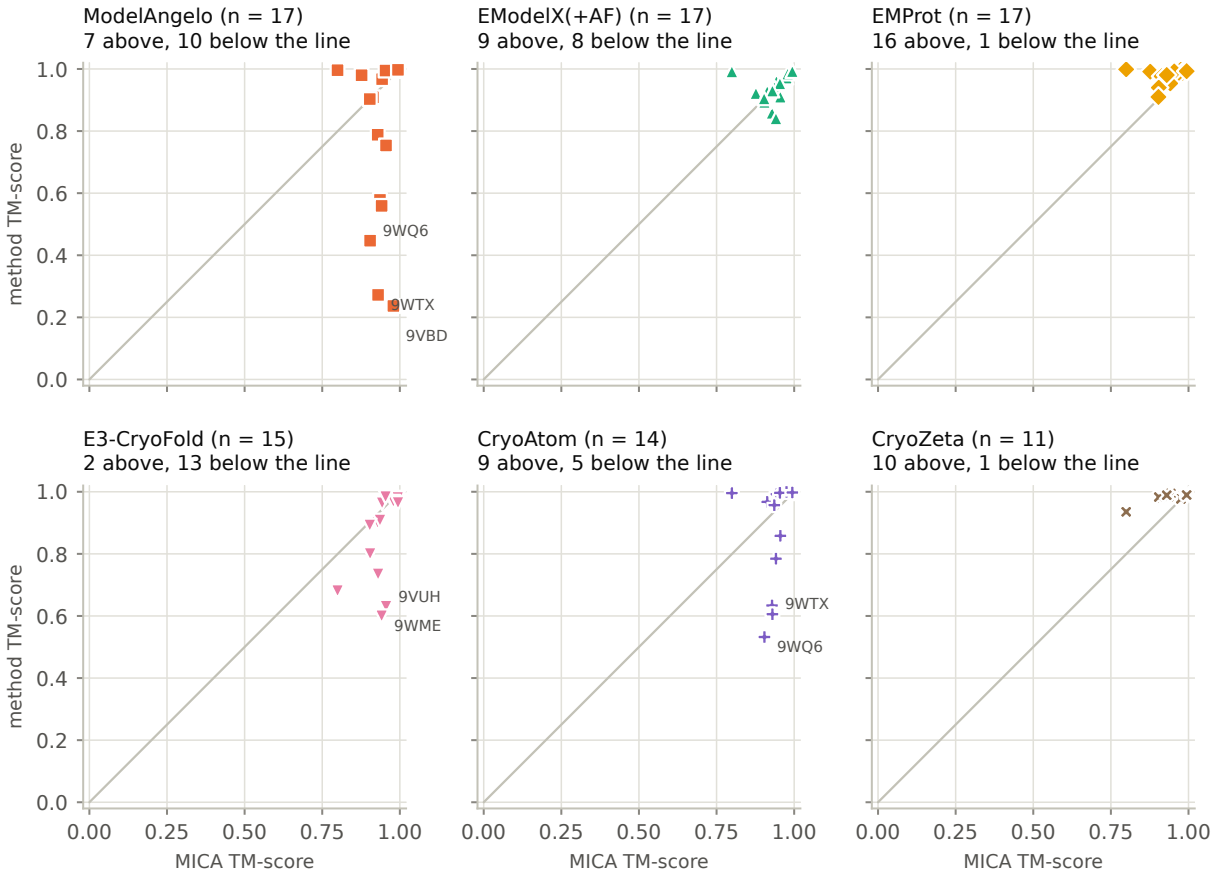


Figure A2. TM-score of each method against that of MICA on the same entry (the line is equality; entries that differ by 0.3 or more are labelled, at most three per panel).

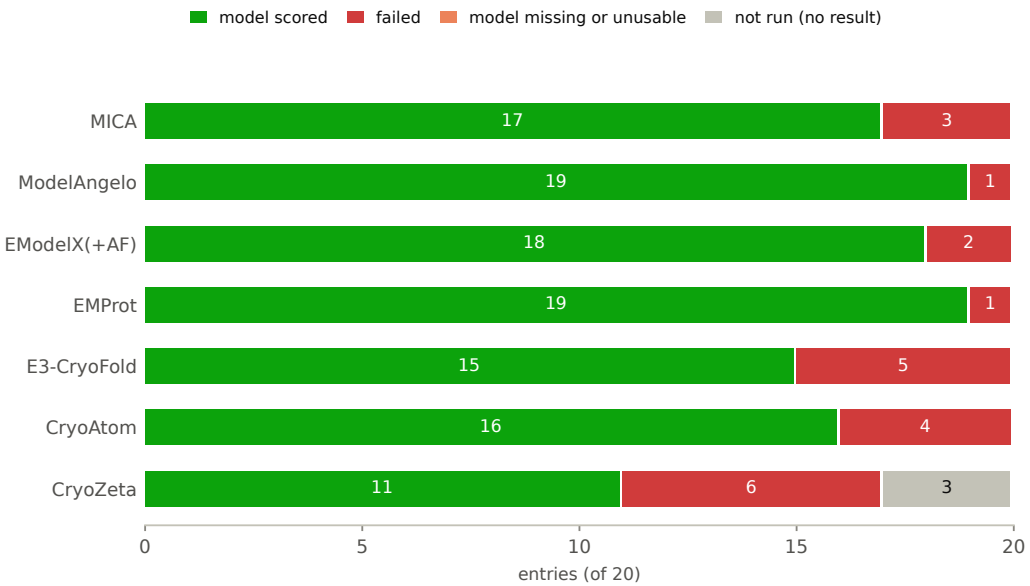


Figure A3. Outcome of the 20 runs of each method (not run: no result, because the run was not started, was cut by the end of a session or was killed without time for a second run).

Table A6. Docking of the AF3 domains in the three passes (Section 4.4): domains docked of the domains found by Merizo, and the median local correlation (CC) of the docked domains. The correlations of pass 1 and pass 3 are not comparable (pass 3 is measured at 6 Å after a coarse refinement). *Mode*: docking mode of the entry in pass 3. The last row sums the domains of the 20 entries; its CC is the median over all docked domains of the pass.

Entry	Domains	Pass 1 docked	CC	Pass 2 docked	CC	Pass 3 docked	CC	Mode
9T5K	2	1 / 2	0.47	1 / 2	0.47	1 / 2	0.11	partial
22FX	2	0 / 2	–	0 / 2	–	1 / 2	0.09	partial
9JKK	2	0 / 2	–	0 / 2	–	2 / 2	0.11	full
9TKA	1	1 / 1	0.44	1 / 1	0.44	1 / 1	0.08	full
9WFL	5	1 / 5	0.47	1 / 5	0.47	5 / 5	0.06	full
9VI4	3	0 / 3	–	0 / 3	–	0 / 3	–	none
9ZLH	2	0 / 2	–	0 / 2	–	2 / 2	0.10	full
9VUH	4	4 / 4	0.42	4 / 4	0.42	4 / 4	0.17	full
9OC0	7	0 / 7	–	0 / 7	–	3 / 7	0.05	partial
13BD	3	2 / 3	0.21	0 / 3	–	1 / 3	0.06	partial
9WQ6	1	0 / 1	–	0 / 1	–	1 / 1	0.03	full
9V4D	1	0 / 1	–	0 / 1	–	1 / 1	0.09	full
9OTA	2	0 / 2	–	0 / 2	–	2 / 2	0.10	full
9KQM	2	1 / 2	0.08	1 / 2	0.08	2 / 2	0.07	full
9WME	7	2 / 7	0.46	2 / 7	0.46	7 / 7	0.08	full
9VBD	4	0 / 4	–	0 / 4	–	4 / 4	0.11	full
9RWS	3	0 / 3	–	0 / 3	–	3 / 3	0.09	full
9WTX	3	0 / 3	–	0 / 3	–	3 / 3	0.10	full
9Z24	3	0 / 3	–	0 / 3	–	1 / 3	0.14	partial
26DK	2	2 / 2	0.53	2 / 2	0.53	2 / 2	0.27	full
All	59	14 / 59	0.44	12 / 59	0.45	46 / 59	0.09	

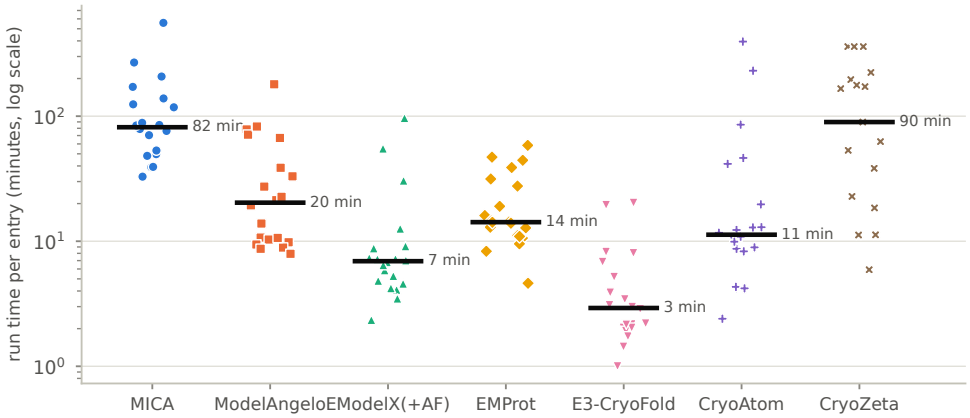


Figure A4. Run time of every run (failed runs included; logarithmic axis); the bar is the median.

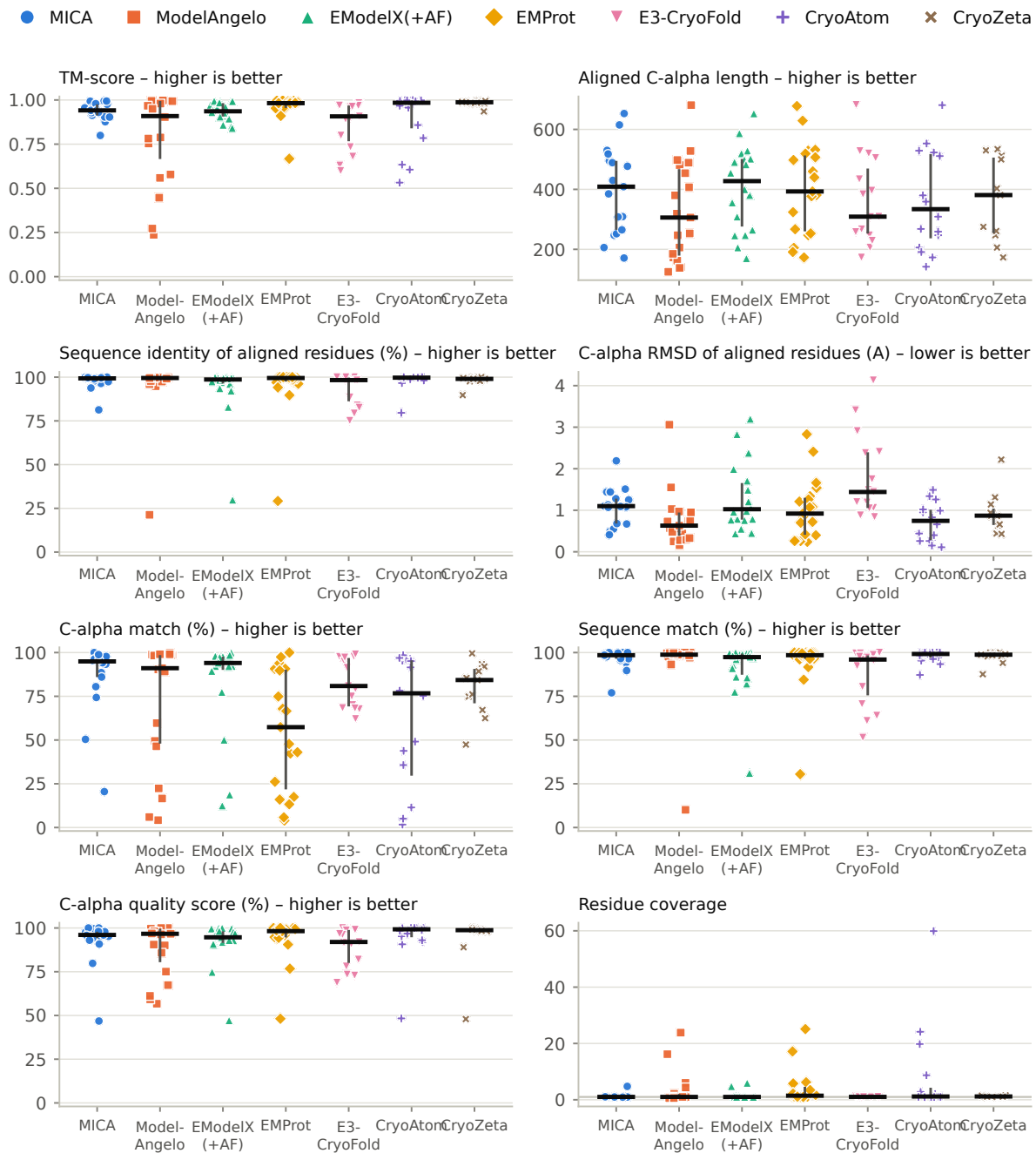


Figure A5. All measures over the scored models of each method (as Figure A1).

Table A7. MICA by entry: domains, domains docked in pass 3, docking mode, outcome of program 3 (*failed → ok*: the first attempt failed with a GPU out-of-memory error and the rerun with the memory patch built the model) and TM-score of the model (F: no model).

Entry	Domains	Docked	Mode	Program 3	TM-score
9T5K	2	1	partial	ok	0.80
22FX	2	1	partial	failed → ok	0.98
9JKK	2	2	full	ok	0.99
9TKA	1	1	full	ok	0.99
9WFL	5	5	full	ok	0.95
9VI4	3	0	none	failed	F
9ZLH	2	2	full	ok	0.99
9VUH	4	4	full	ok	0.96
9OC0	7	3	partial	failed	F
13BD	3	1	partial	ok	0.88
9WQ6	1	1	full	failed → ok	0.90
9V4D	1	1	full	failed → ok	0.94
9OTA	2	2	full	ok	0.91
9KQM	2	2	full	ok	0.93
9WME	7	7	full	ok	0.94
9VBD	4	4	full	ok	0.98
9RWS	3	3	full	ok	0.94
9WTX	3	3	full	ok	0.93
9Z24	3	1	partial	ok	0.90
26DK	2	2	full	failed	F

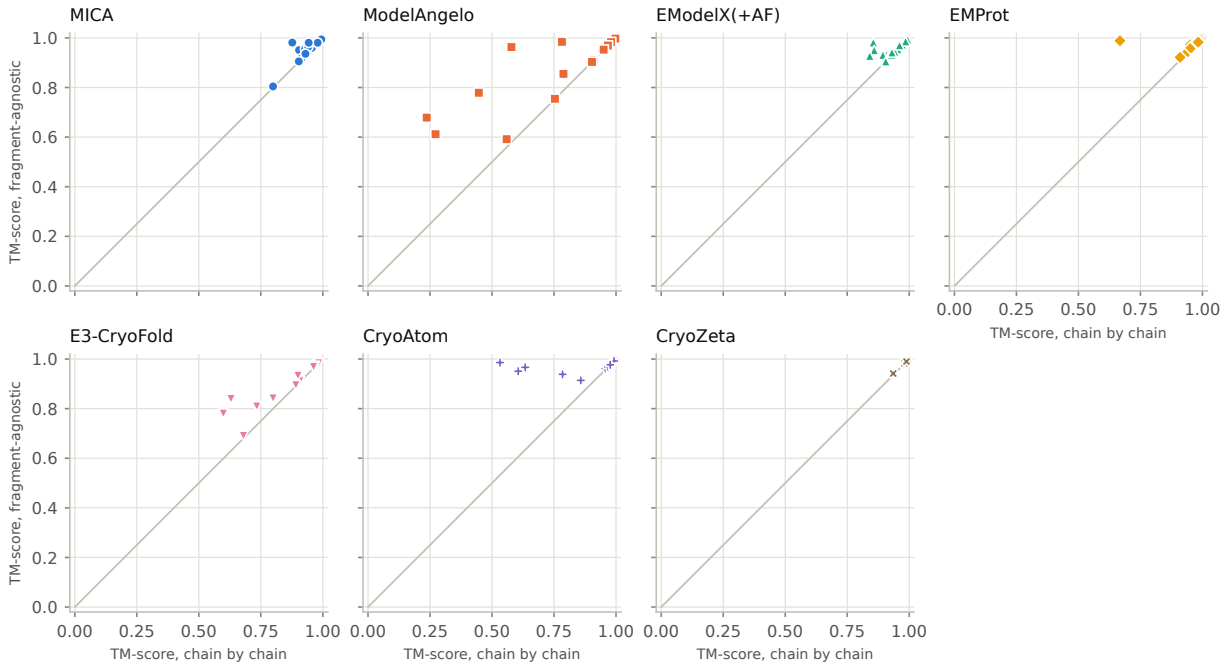


Figure A6. TM-score chain by chain (the primary measure) against the fragment-agnostic TM-score. A point above the line is a model whose primary score is lowered by fragmentation or by extra chains.

Table A8. Every run that ended without a scored model, with the reason recorded by the notebook. Exit code −9 is a kill by the system.

Entry	Method	Outcome	Reason (from the status table)
13BD	E3-CryoFold	failed	prealign: exit code 1; the model file 13BD_e3_prealign.pdb was not written
13BD	CryoAtom	failed	build: out of GPU memory (exit code 1; the error message of the program); the model file 13BD_cryoatom1.cif was not written
13BD	CryoZeta	failed	run: out of GPU memory (exit code 2; the error message of the program); the model file 13BD_sample_0.cif was not written
26DK	MICA	failed	3_build: exit code -9; the output of 3_build was not written
26DK	EModelX(+AF)	failed	temp_flex: killed by the system (exit code -9, probably out of memory); the model file 26dk_EModelX(+AF)_all_atom_model.pdb was not written
26DK	E3-CryoFold	failed	prealign: killed by the system (exit code -9, probably out of memory); the model file 26DK_e3_prealign.pdb was not written
26DK	CryoZeta	failed	run: killed by the system (exit code -9, probably out of memory; also when it ran alone); the model file 26DK_sample_0.cif was not written
9OC0	MICA	failed	3_build: timeout after 7200 s; the output of 3_build was not written
9OC0	E3-CryoFold	failed	prealign: exit code 1; the model file 9OC0_e3_prealign.pdb was not written
9OC0	CryoAtom	failed	build: out of GPU memory (exit code 1; the error message of the program); the model file 9OC0_cryoatom1.cif was not written
9OC0	CryoZeta	failed	run: killed by the system (exit code -9, probably out of memory; also when it ran alone); the model file 9OC0_sample_0.cif was not written
9OTA	E3-CryoFold	failed	prealign: exit code 1; the model file 9OTA_e3_prealign.pdb was not written
9VBD	CryoAtom	failed	build: out of GPU memory (exit code 1; the error message of the program); the model file 9VBD_cryoatom1.cif was not written
9VBD	CryoZeta	failed	run: timeout: the run limit of 21600 s; the model file 9VBD_sample_0.cif was not written
9VI4	MICA	failed	3_build: exit code -9; the output of 3_build was not written
9VI4	ModelAngelo	failed	build: timeout: the run limit of 10800 s; the model file 9VI4_modelangelo.cif was not written
9VI4	EModelX(+AF)	failed	temp_flex: killed by the system (exit code -9, probably out of memory); the model file 9vi4_EModelX(+AF)_all_atom_model.pdb was not written
9VI4	EMProt	failed	build: killed by the system (exit code -9, probably out of memory); the model file output.cif was not written
9VI4	E3-CryoFold	failed	prealign: killed by the system (exit code -9, probably out of memory); the model file 9VI4_e3_prealign.pdb was not written
9VI4	CryoZeta	not run	killed_corun: killed by the system (exit code -9, probably out of memory) while the other GPU's program ran; run again alone
9VUH	CryoZeta	failed	run: timeout: the run limit of 21600 s; the model file 9VUH_sample_0.cif was not written
9WFL	CryoZeta	not run	interrupted: stopped by the end of the session after 17039 s; run again in the next session
9WME	CryoZeta	not run	interrupted: stopped by the end of the session after 17022 s; run again in the next session
9Z24	CryoAtom	failed	build: out of GPU memory (exit code 1; the error message of the program); the model file 9Z24_cryoatom1.cif was not written

Table A9. Failed runs scored as zero: mean TM-score and the paired comparison with MICA. The two policies give the same means and tests for the methods that were run on all 20 entries, because every run was either scored or failed (the intervals can differ in the last digit because the bootstrap draws differ); they differ for CryoZeta, whose entries not run are left out in the first policy, because they are not failures, and counted as zero in the second.

Method	n	Mean TM-score [95% CI]	Mean diff. to MICA	Wilcoxon p	Holm p
Failed and unusable runs scored 0 (runs not made are left out)					
MICA	20	0.80 [0.64, 0.93]	–	–	–
ModelAngelo	20	0.76 [0.62, 0.88]	−0.04	0.738	1.000
EModelX(+AF)	20	0.84 [0.70, 0.94]	0.05	0.551	1.000
EMProt	20	0.91 [0.80, 0.98]	0.12	<0.001	<0.001
E3-CryoFold	20	0.65 [0.46, 0.81]	−0.15	0.002	0.008
CryoAtom	20	0.71 [0.54, 0.87]	−0.08	0.651	1.000
CryoZeta	17	0.64 [0.40, 0.87]	−0.19	0.934	1.000
Every missing result scored 0					
MICA	20	0.80 [0.64, 0.93]	–	–	–
ModelAngelo	20	0.76 [0.62, 0.88]	−0.04	0.738	1.000
EModelX(+AF)	20	0.84 [0.70, 0.94]	0.05	0.551	1.000
EMProt	20	0.91 [0.80, 0.98]	0.12	<0.001	<0.001
E3-CryoFold	20	0.65 [0.47, 0.81]	−0.15	0.002	0.008
CryoAtom	20	0.71 [0.54, 0.87]	−0.08	0.651	1.000
CryoZeta	20	0.54 [0.34, 0.74]	−0.26	0.517	1.000

Table A10. MICA with and without docked AF3 input on the entries that ran in both set-ups (difference = docked minus no docked input).

Entry	Res. (Å)	Docking	TM docked	TM no docked input	Difference
9JKK	3.00	full	0.995	0.991	+0.004
9WFL	2.75	full	0.954	0.954	0.000
9ZLH	2.14	full	0.994	0.994	0.000
9VUH	2.70	full	0.956	0.909	+0.047
9OTA	3.20	full	0.913	0.913	+0.001
9KQM	3.50	full	0.929	0.856	+0.073
9WME	3.20	full	0.941	0.929	+0.012
9RWS	3.28	full	0.943	0.942	+0.001
Mean difference 0.017 [0.002, 0.037]; median 0.002; Wilcoxon p = 0.039; higher / lower / equal: 6 / 2 / 0					

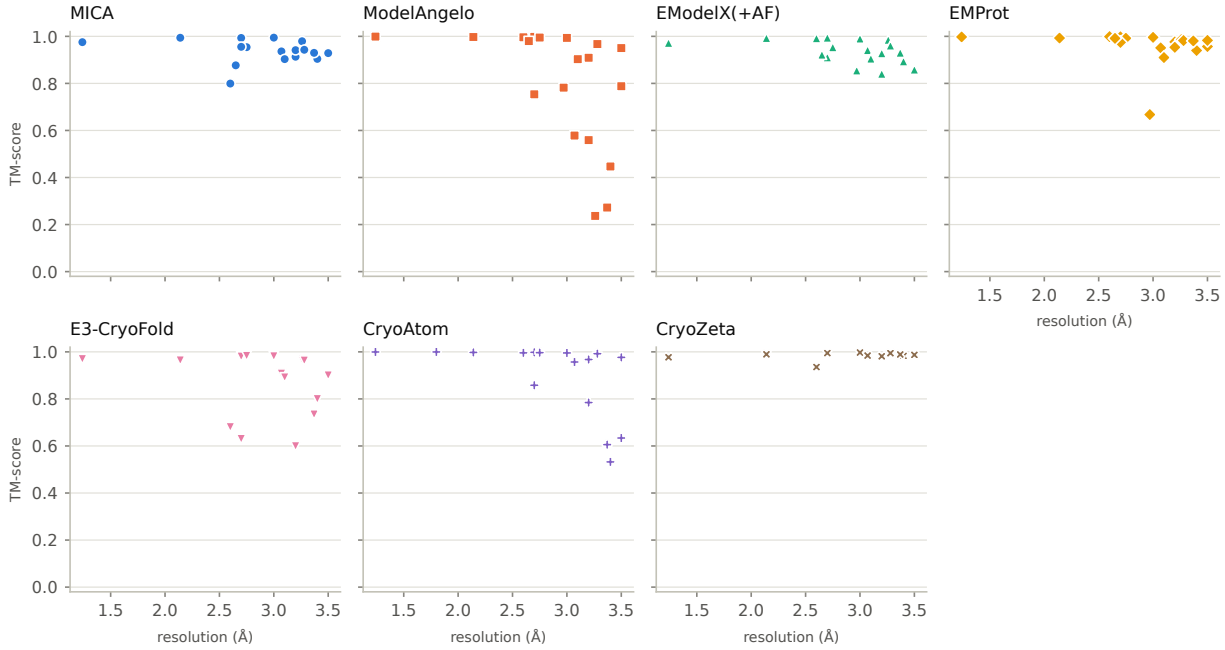


Figure A7. TM-score of each method against the resolution of the map.

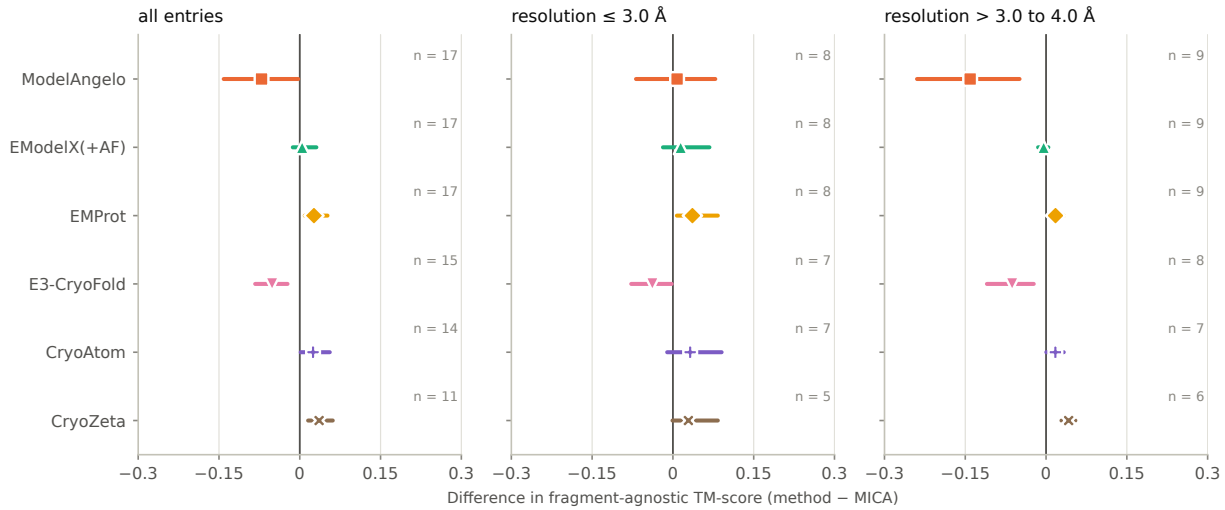


Figure A8. Difference between each method and MICA in the fragment-agnostic TM-score (as Figure 2).

Table A11. TM-score of every method on every entry (normalised by the deposited model; F: failed run; N: not run).

Entry	Res. (Å)	MICA	ModelAngelo	EModelX(+AF)	EMProt	E3-CryoFold	CryoAtom	CryoZeta
Resolution $\leq$ 3.0 Å								
9T5K	2.60	0.80	1.00	0.99	1.00	0.68	1.00	0.94
22FX	1.24	0.98	1.00	0.97	1.00	0.97	1.00	0.98
9JKK	3.00	0.99	0.99	0.99	1.00	0.98	1.00	1.00
9TKA	2.70	0.99	1.00	0.99	1.00	0.98	1.00	0.99
9WFL	2.75	0.95	0.99	0.95	0.99	0.98	1.00	N
9VI4	1.80	F	F	F	F	F	1.00	N
9ZLH	2.14	0.99	1.00	0.99	0.99	0.96	1.00	0.99
9VUH	2.70	0.96	0.75	0.91	0.97	0.63	0.86	F
9OC0	2.97	F	0.78	0.86	0.67	F	F	F
13BD	2.65	0.88	0.98	0.92	0.99	F	F	F
Resolution > 3.0 to 4.0 Å								
9WQ6	3.40	0.90	0.45	0.89	0.94	0.80	0.53	0.98
9V4D	3.07	0.94	0.58	0.94	0.95	0.91	0.96	0.98
9OTA	3.20	0.91	0.91	0.93	0.98	F	0.97	0.98
9KQM	3.50	0.93	0.79	0.86	0.96	0.90	0.63	0.99
9WME	3.20	0.94	0.56	0.84	0.95	0.60	0.78	N
9VBD	3.26	0.98	0.24	0.99	0.99	0.97	F	F
9RWS	3.28	0.94	0.97	0.96	0.98	0.96	0.99	0.99
9WTX	3.37	0.93	0.27	0.93	0.98	0.73	0.61	0.99
9Z24	3.10	0.90	0.90	0.91	0.91	0.89	F	F
26DK	3.50	F	0.95	F	0.98	F	0.98	F

Table A12. Median (interquartile range) of every measure (Table 2) over the scored models of each method. The sets of entries differ between methods.

Metric	MICA	ModelAngelo	EModelX(+AF)	EMProt	E3-CryoFold	CryoAtom	CryoZeta
TM-score	0.94 (0.91–0.98)	0.91 (0.67–0.99)	0.94 (0.91–0.98)	0.98 (0.96–0.99)	0.91 (0.77–0.97)	0.98 (0.84–1.00)	0.99 (0.98–0.99)
Cα match (%)	94.9 (86.0–96.3)	91.1 (48.0–98.5)	94.1 (90.1–97.6)	57.4 (21.8–90.2)	80.9 (69.2–96.9)	76.7 (29.6–95.6)	84.3 (71.0–90.7)
Sequence match (%)	98.5 (96.5–99.7)	98.8 (98.1–99.8)	97.4 (87.3–99.4)	98.5 (96.5–99.7)	96.0 (75.5–98.3)	99.2 (97.0–100.0)	98.8 (97.9–99.6)
Coverage	1.02 (1.00–1.05)	1.01 (0.89–2.06)	1.01 (0.98–1.04)	1.45 (1.08–4.59)	1.03 (1.00–1.16)	1.16 (1.02–4.28)	1.17 (1.06–1.24)
Cα quality (%)	96.0 (94.2–97.9)	96.7 (80.5–99.5)	94.7 (91.4–98.1)	98.2 (94.6–99.7)	92.0 (80.0–98.9)	99.2 (94.7–100.0)	98.8 (98.2–99.3)
Aligned sequence identity (%)	99.3 (97.8–99.7)	99.5 (98.3–99.9)	98.7 (96.3–99.6)	99.5 (97.5–100.0)	98.3 (86.2–99.8)	99.7 (98.8–100.0)	99.0 (98.3–100.0)
RMSD (Å)	1.10 (0.68–1.28)	0.63 (0.39–0.94)	1.02 (0.78–1.66)	0.92 (0.41–1.30)	1.44 (1.05–2.40)	0.74 (0.28–1.01)	0.87 (0.65–1.04)
Aligned length	409 (265–495)	306 (179–468)	428 (276–501)	393 (260–513)	309 (252–470)	334 (237–518)	381 (254–506)

Table A13. TM-score by resolution stratum: entries, scored models, median (interquartile range) and mean with 95 % bootstrap CI.

Method	Entries	Models	Median (IQR)	Mean [95% CI]
Resolution ≤ 3.0 Å				
MICA	10	8	0.97 (0.93–0.99)	0.94 [0.89, 0.98]
ModelAngelo	10	9	0.99 (0.98–1.00)	0.94 [0.87, 1.00]
EModelX(+AF)	10	9	0.97 (0.92–0.99)	0.95 [0.92, 0.98]
EMProt	10	9	0.99 (0.99–1.00)	0.96 [0.88, 1.00]
E3-CryoFold	10	7	0.97 (0.82–0.98)	0.88 [0.77, 0.98]
CryoAtom	10	8	1.00 (1.00–1.00)	0.98 [0.94, 1.00]
CryoZeta	10	5	0.99 (0.98–0.99)	0.98 [0.96, 0.99]
Resolution > 3.0 to 4.0 Å				
MICA	10	9	0.93 (0.91–0.94)	0.93 [0.92, 0.95]
ModelAngelo	10	10	0.68 (0.47–0.91)	0.66 [0.49, 0.82]
EModelX(+AF)	10	9	0.93 (0.89–0.94)	0.92 [0.89, 0.94]
EMProt	10	10	0.97 (0.95–0.98)	0.96 [0.95, 0.98]
E3-CryoFold	10	8	0.90 (0.78–0.92)	0.85 [0.76, 0.92]
CryoAtom	10	8	0.87 (0.63–0.97)	0.81 [0.68, 0.93]
CryoZeta	10	6	0.99 (0.98–0.99)	0.99 [0.98, 0.99]

Table A14. Fragment-agnostic TM-score (US-align `-mm 5`): median (interquartile range) over the scored models, and the paired comparison with MICA on the entries where both built a model (method minus MICA; Wilcoxon p and its Holm correction over the six methods). n is the number of models with this score; for CryoAtom it is 15, not 16, because the model of 9VI4 has more residues than the PDB format can number (Section 5).

Method	n	TM-score, fragment-agnostic, median (IQR)	Mean difference to MICA [95% CI]	Wilcoxon p	Holm p
MICA	17	0.96 (0.94–0.98)	–	–	–
ModelAngelo	19	0.96 (0.82–0.99)	−0.07 [−0.14, −0.00]	0.243	0.487
EModelX(+AF)	18	0.95 (0.93–0.98)	0.00 [−0.01, 0.03]	0.464	0.487
EMProt	19	0.99 (0.98–0.99)	0.03 [0.01, 0.05]	0.002	0.010
E3-CryoFold	15	0.93 (0.84–0.97)	−0.05 [−0.08, −0.02]	0.002	0.010
CryoAtom	15	0.99 (0.96–1.00)	0.02 [0.00, 0.06]	0.049	0.148
CryoZeta	11	0.99 (0.98–0.99)	0.04 [0.02, 0.06]	0.005	0.020

Table A15. Further output files of each method, scored with the same protocol next to the file of the main comparison (marked *scored*); *n* is the number of entries with the file. Only the file marked *scored* is used in the comparisons.

Output	*n*	TM-score, median	TM-score, mean	Fragment-agnostic TM, median	Cα match, median	Coverage, median	Cα quality, median
MICA, all-atom model (scored)	17	0.94	0.94	0.96	94.9	1.02	96.0
MICA, Cα model after chain building	17	0.94	0.94	0.96	94.9	1.02	96.2
MICA, initial Cα model of the network	17	0.82	0.82	0.86	99.5	0.86	84.4
ModelAngelo, sequence-assigned model (scored)	19	0.91	0.79	0.96	91.1	1.01	96.7
ModelAngelo, model without sequence assignment	19	0.50	0.50	0.99	48.5	1.47	98.2
EModelX(+AF), all-atom model (scored)	18	0.94	0.94	0.95	94.1	1.01	94.7
EModelX(+AF), Cα model	18	0.94	0.94	0.95	94.1	1.01	94.7
EMProt, build with the AF3 models (scored)	19	0.98	0.96	0.99	57.4	1.45	98.2
EMProt, de novo model	19	0.96	0.82	0.97	97.2	1.00	97.1
E3-CryoFold, `pre_align` model (scored)	15	0.91	0.86	0.93	80.9	1.03	92.0
CryoAtom v1.0.0, pruned model (scored)	16	0.98	0.89	0.99	76.7	1.16	99.2
CryoAtom v1.0.0, model before pruning	16	0.78	0.75	0.99	36.7	2.04	99.8
CryoZeta, top-ranked sample 0 (scored)	11	0.99	0.98	0.99	84.3	1.17	98.8
CryoZeta, sample 1 (ranked second)	11	0.99	0.98	0.99	84.3	1.17	99.3
CryoZeta, sample 2 (ranked third)	11	0.99	0.98	0.99	84.3	1.17	99.0
CryoZeta, sample 3 (ranked fourth)	11	0.99	0.98	0.99	85.5	1.17	98.9
CryoZeta, sample 4 (ranked fifth)	11	0.99	0.98	0.99	84.3	1.17	98.8

Table A16. Spearman rank correlation (two-sided *p* in brackets, not corrected for multiple tests) of the TM-score with the resolution of the map, the number of modelled residues and the highest identity to older PDB entries; *n* is the number of scored models.

Method	*n*	Resolution	Modelled residues	Identity to older PDB
MICA	17	−0.25 (0.325)	0.03 (0.896)	0.02 (0.940)
ModelAngelo	19	−0.66 (0.002)	−0.29 (0.237)	0.05 (0.835)
EModelX(+AF)	18	−0.48 (0.044)	−0.18 (0.463)	−0.42 (0.080)
EMProt	19	−0.53 (0.018)	−0.13 (0.609)	−0.28 (0.247)
E3-CryoFold	15	−0.28 (0.305)	−0.00 (0.990)	−0.11 (0.685)
CryoAtom	16	−0.79 (<0.001)	−0.14 (0.617)	−0.10 (0.715)
CryoZeta	11	0.11 (0.750)	0.19 (0.574)	−0.25 (0.462)

Table A17. Wall-clock time per run (failed runs included). For MICA it is the time of programs 1 to 3 including docking; the baselines ran with another program on the second GPU of the session, so the times are indicative.

Method	Runs	Median (min)	Range (min)	Total (h)	Device
MICA	20	81.6	32.8–557.5	40.0	cuda
ModelAngelo	20	20.3	7.9–180.0	12.2	0, 1
EModelX(+AF)	20	6.9	2.4–96.8	4.8	0, 1
EMProt	20	14.2	4.6–58.5	7.0	0, 1
E3-CryoFold	20	2.9	1.0–20.3	1.7	0, 1
CryoAtom	20	11.3	2.4–394.9	15.7	0, 1
CryoZeta	17	89.8	5.9–360.0	38.8	0, 1

Table A18. Paired comparison of the TM-score with MICA run without docked input, on the entries where that run and the method both have a model (method minus MICA; as Table 5).

Method	Pairs	Mean difference [95% CI]	Median diff.	Wilcoxon p	Holm p	t-test Holm p	higher / lower / equal
All entries							
ModelAngelo	8	−0.07 [−0.17, 0.01]	0.00	0.461	1.000	0.884	4 / 4 / 0
EModelX(+AF)	8	−0.01 [−0.03, 0.01]	0.00	0.617	1.000	0.884	4 / 4 / 0
EMProt	8	0.04 [0.02, 0.07]	0.04	0.016	0.094	0.061	7 / 1 / 0
E3-CryoFold	7	−0.08 [−0.20, 0.02]	−0.01	0.578	1.000	0.884	3 / 4 / 0
CryoAtom	8	−0.03 [−0.10, 0.03]	0.00	0.844	1.000	0.884	5 / 3 / 0
CryoZeta	5	0.05 [0.01, 0.09]	0.05	0.125	0.625	0.528	4 / 1 / 0
Resolution ≤ 3.0 Å							
ModelAngelo	4	−0.03 [−0.12, 0.03]	0.00	0.875	1.000	1.000	3 / 1 / 0
EModelX(+AF)	4	0.00 [−0.00, 0.00]	0.00	0.750	1.000	1.000	1 / 3 / 0
EMProt	4	0.03 [0.00, 0.05]	0.02	0.250	1.000	1.000	3 / 1 / 0
E3-CryoFold	4	−0.07 [−0.21, 0.01]	−0.02	0.375	1.000	1.000	1 / 3 / 0
CryoAtom	4	−0.00 [−0.04, 0.03]	0.00	0.875	1.000	1.000	3 / 1 / 0
CryoZeta	2	0.00 [−0.00, 0.01]	0.00	1.000	1.000	1.000	1 / 1 / 0
Resolution > 3.0 to 4.0 Å							
ModelAngelo	4	−0.10 [−0.28, 0.01]	−0.04	0.375	1.000	1.000	1 / 3 / 0
EModelX(+AF)	4	−0.01 [−0.06, 0.02]	0.01	0.875	1.000	1.000	3 / 1 / 0
EMProt	4	0.06 [0.03, 0.09]	0.05	0.125	0.750	0.248	4 / 0 / 0
E3-CryoFold	3	−0.09 [−0.33, 0.04]	0.02	1.000	1.000	1.000	2 / 1 / 0
CryoAtom	4	−0.07 [−0.18, 0.05]	−0.05	0.625	1.000	1.000	2 / 2 / 0
CryoZeta	3	0.08 [0.05, 0.13]	0.07	0.250	1.000	0.365	3 / 0 / 0